

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 7

The Cold War & Postwar America

*Superpower Rivalry · Containment · Korea & Vietnam · Nuclear Fears · Space Race
· Détente & the Fall of the Wall · 1945–1991*

Standards US.59 – US.70

US.59

US.60

US.61

US.62

US.63

US.64

US.65

US.66

US.67

US.68

US.69

US.70

UNIT ROADMAP

Where We Are Headed

Unit 7 • The Cold War & Postwar America (1945–1991) — Superpower Rivalry, Containment, the Red Scare, Korea and Vietnam, Nuclear Fears, the Space Race, and the End of the Cold War



BELL RINGER · HOOK

For nearly half a century after World War II, two superpowers — the United States and the Soviet Union — never fired a shot directly at each other, yet they built enough weapons to destroy the world many times over and pulled nearly every nation on Earth into their rivalry.

From Berlin to Korea, Cuba to Vietnam, and the surface of the Moon to the Berlin Wall, the Cold War shaped American policy, society, and daily life for two generations.

How could two nations wage a decades-long "war" without ever meeting on the battlefield — and how did that rivalry finally come to a peaceful end?

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three ways two rival superpowers could compete WITHOUT going to war with each other directly. Then predict: which do you think would be most dangerous to the rest of the world? Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

STANDARD

US.59

U.S.-Soviet Competition

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.04

Build an argument

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the competition between the U.S. and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of NATO, SEATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

I CAN

I can describe the competition between the U.S. and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of NATO, SEATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

How This Deck Works — UDL 3.0 & MTSS

Teacher reference · CAST UDL 3.0 guidelines designed into every standard

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

ENGAGEMENT

Multiple means of the “why”

- Welcoming Interests & Identities
- Sustaining Effort & Persistence
- Emotional Capacity

REPRESENTATION

Multiple means of the “what”

- Perception
- Language & Symbols
- Building Knowledge

ACTION & EXPRESSION

Multiple means of the “how”

- Interaction
- Expression & Communication
- Strategy Development

MTSS decision cycle: Tier 1 core for all → the Progress Check yields evidence → below mastery routes to targeted reteach (Tier 2, Teacher Guide §16); at/above mastery routes to extension. **The goal never lowers.**

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 6 What global war did we just finish studying, and how did its ending set the stage for the Cold War?

2

Unit Hook What is the big question of Unit 7?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name the two superpowers whose rivalry defined the Cold War.

✓ **ANSWER**

The United States and the Soviet Union.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

For nearly half a century after World War II, two superpowers, the United States and the Soviet Union, never fired a shot directly at each other, yet they raced to build enough weapons to destroy the world many times over and pulled nearly every nation on Earth into their rivalry.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How could two nations wage a decades-long 'war' without ever meeting on the battlefield, and why did their competition threaten the entire planet?

Arms Race Rivalry

- The arms race began with nuclear weapons development—the U.S. had atomic bombs by 1945, the USSR by 1949.
- Both nations rapidly developed hydrogen bombs, intercontinental ballistic missiles (ICBMs), and submarine-launched missiles.
- Each side sought nuclear superiority, leading to massive stockpiles that could destroy the world multiple times over, creating a "balance of terror."

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The U.S. and the Soviet Union competed during the Cold War by _____ and _____, without ever fighting each other directly.

Economic Competition

- The U.S. promoted capitalism and free markets globally, while the USSR pushed communist planned economies.
- Both competed to demonstrate their economic system's superiority through foreign aid, trade relationships, and development projects in developing nations.
- The Marshall Plan exemplified American economic diplomacy, rebuilding Western Europe while creating markets for American goods.

Ideological Differences

- The United States championed democracy, individual freedoms, free market capitalism, and religious liberty.
- The Soviet Union promoted communist authoritarianism, collective ownership, state-controlled economy, and atheism.
- These fundamentally incompatible worldviews drove competition in every arena from sports to space exploration.

Military Alliances

- NATO (1949) was a Western alliance led by the U.S. for mutual defense against Soviet expansion.
- SEATO (1954) provided Southeast Asian collective defense against communist expansion.
- The Warsaw Pact (1955) was the Soviet-led Eastern European military alliance responding to NATO.
- These alliances divided the world into competing blocs.



Abbie Rowe / National Park Service / Harry S. Truman Library; National Archives and Records Administration, 1949 [National Archives](#)

Key Figures

Harry S. Truman

33rd President (1945-1953)

- Led the U.S. into the early Cold War against the Soviet Union
- Defined the American strategy of containment
- Backed NATO to unite Western democracies against Soviet power

STRATEGY Use Truman to personify the moment the U.S. accepted a permanent superpower role.

Joseph Stalin

Soviet dictator (1878-1953)

- Led the USSR as the rival superpower after WWII
- Imposed communist control across Eastern Europe
- Rejected Western democracy and capitalism

STRATEGY Pair Stalin with Truman so students see the rivalry as two systems, not just two men.

NATO Treaty (Article 5)

Close Reading

North Atlantic Treaty Organization • April 4, 1949

"The Parties agree that an armed attack against one or more of them in Europe or North America shall be considered an attack against them all and consequently they agree that... each of them... will assist the Party or Parties so attacked by taking forthwith... such action as it deems necessary, including the use of armed force."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In 1949, the Soviet Union had recently tested its first atomic bomb and Communist forces were about to complete their takeover of China. Western European nations feared Soviet expansion and sought American protection. NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization) was created in April 1949 as a mutual defense alliance of Western democracies—the first peacetime military alliance in American history—committing the U.S. to defend Europe against Soviet attack.

ANALYZE

What commitment does Article 5 of the NATO Treaty establish?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? North Atlantic Treaty Organization	WHEN? April 4, 1949	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [Avalon Project, Yale Law School](#)

Word Wall

Cold War

say: kohld wor

Guerra Fría

CW

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Capitalism

say: KAP-ih-tul-iz-um

Capitalismo

C

An economic system based on private ownership, free markets, and competition, where individuals and businesses operate for profit, championed by the United States as superior to Soviet communism.

Proxy War

say: PROX-ee war

Guerra por Poder

PW

Conflicts where the United States and Soviet Union supported opposing sides without directly fighting each other, allowing superpower competition while avoiding nuclear war.

Superpower

say: SUE-per-ah

Superpotencia

S

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

Communism

say: KOM-yoo-niz-um

Comunismo

C

A political and economic system where the government owns all property and means of production, theoretically distributing resources equally, practiced in the Soviet Union and opposed by the United States during...

Iron Curtain

say: EYE-ern KUR-tun

Cortina de Hierro

IC

Winston Churchill's metaphor for the political, military, and ideological barrier dividing Soviet-controlled Eastern Europe from Western Europe after World War II, symbolizing the split between communist and...

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Compare two systems

MODEL PROMPT: How did the U.S. and Soviet systems differ, and why did that cause conflict?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The U.S. defended capitalism and democracy; the USSR imposed communism and one-party rule. Each saw the other's model as a threat to spread, so their rivalry became global.

THINK ALOUD

In the section, underline one U.S. value and one Soviet value that clashed.

→ **Now you try:** *With a partner, name the single difference you think mattered most, citing a line.*

Two Superpowers, Four Arenas — Mapping U.S.-Soviet Competition

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the NATO Treaty (Article 5) excerpt, build a four-column chart labeled ARMS RACE, ECONOMIC, IDEOLOGICAL, and ALLIANCES. For each arena, record how the United States and the Soviet Union competed and one concrete example (nuclear stockpiles, capitalism vs. command economy, democracy vs. communism, NATO vs. the Warsaw Pact). Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on which arena of competition posed the greatest danger to world peace.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-arena chart (U.S. vs. USSR + one example each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the most dangerous arena.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four arenas pre-labeled and a word bank of examples to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using Article 5 to explain how a mutual-defense alliance could make a wider war both less and more likely.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us59-us-soviet-competition.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A** They divided Europe into opposing military blocs aligned with either American capitalism or Soviet communism.
- B** Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense.
- C** NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations.
- D** The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A** They divided Europe into opposing military blocs aligned with either American capitalism or Soviet communism. ✓
- B** Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense.
- C** NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations.
- D** The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament.

Correct answer: A. Why: NATO (1949) aligned Western democracies under U.S. leadership; the Warsaw Pact (1955) formalized Soviet bloc military cooperation, institutionalizing the ideological divide across Europe.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Arms Race Rivalry
- Economic Competition
- Ideological Differences
- Military Alliances

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the Cold War primarily a military rivalry, an economic one, or a battle of ideas? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the U.S. and the Soviet Union competed during the Cold War. Identify at least two different areas of competition.

STANDARD

US.60

Containment and Early Cold War Policies

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

I CAN

I can explain the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

Words you need before we read

Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Superpower

En español: *Superpotencia*

WHAT IT MEANS

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

Capitalism

En español: *Capitalismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

An economic system based on private ownership, free markets, and competition, where individuals and businesses operate for profit, championed by the United States as superior to Soviet communism.

Check your understanding

Compare how the U.S. and USSR used economic aid and trade to compete for global influence during the Cold War.

- A** Both nations used economic assistance—like the U.S. Marshall Plan—to win allies, demonstrate their system's superiority, and expand their spheres of influence ✓ KEY
- B** Only the U.S. provided economic aid to other nations, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, which does not align with the documented historical record
- C** Economic competition was not part of the Cold War, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D** The USSR provided more economic aid than the U.S, which does not reflect the consensus among historians when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.59 Name the two superpowers of the Cold War and one way they competed.

2

US.59 What military alliance did the U.S. and Western Europe form in 1949?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What U.S. policy aimed to stop the spread of communism?

✓ **ANSWER**

Containment.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

As World War II ended, Soviet armies stayed in Eastern Europe and an 'iron curtain' fell across the continent; in response, the United States pledged to hold the line against the spread of communism, spending billions to rebuild Europe and flying supplies into a blockaded Berlin.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a rival power expands, should a nation confront it everywhere at once, or pick its battles, and what did the American policy of containment actually require?

The Long Telegram and Containment

- George Kennan's 1946 "Long Telegram" argued that the USSR was inherently expansionist and must be contained through firm resistance.
- This became the foundation for containment policy—preventing Soviet expansion without direct military confrontation.
- Kennan believed that if confined, the Soviet system would eventually collapse from internal weaknesses.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Containment meant _____, and the U.S. carried it out through _____ and _____.

The Truman Doctrine

- Announced in 1947, the Truman Doctrine committed the U.S. to supporting free peoples resisting communist subjugation.
- Initially applied to Greece and Turkey facing communist pressures, it became the framework for global anti-communist intervention.
- This represented a major shift from American isolationism to global engagement.

The Marshall Plan

- Objectives: Rebuild Western European economies, create markets for American goods, and prevent communist takeover of war-torn nations.
- Outcomes: The Marshall Plan successfully rebuilt Europe, strengthened NATO allies, and demonstrated American commitment to European recovery.
- It provided over \$13 billion in aid and is considered one of the most successful foreign policy initiatives in American history.

The Berlin Airlift

- When Soviets blocked land access to West Berlin (1948-49), the U.S. and Britain airlifted supplies for 11 months.
- At its peak, planes landed every few minutes, delivering food, fuel, and medicine to over 2 million West Berliners.
- This demonstrated Western resolve without military confrontation and established Berlin as a Cold War symbol of freedom versus oppression.



U.S. Air Force / U.S. Federal Government, 1948 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Key Figures

Harry S. Truman

33rd President; author of containment

- Announced the Truman Doctrine (1947) to aid Greece and Turkey
- Backed the Marshall Plan to rebuild Western Europe
- Ordered the Berlin Airlift to break the Soviet blockade

STRATEGY Trace Truman's steps - Doctrine, Plan, Airlift - as containment moving from words to action.

George C. Marshall

Secretary of State (1947-1949)

- Proposed the European Recovery Program (Marshall Plan)
- Aimed to rebuild Europe and block communism with aid, not arms
- Won the 1953 Nobel Peace Prize for the plan

STRATEGY Use Marshall to show containment's economic side, not just its military side.

The Truman Doctrine Speech

President Harry S. Truman • March 12, 1947

Close Reading

"I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures. I believe that we must assist free peoples to work out their own destinies in their own way. I believe that our help should be primarily through economic and financial aid."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

After World War II, Greece was torn by civil war between government forces and Communist guerrillas, and Turkey faced Soviet pressure for territorial concessions. Britain, which had previously supported Greece, told the U.S. in early 1947 that it could no longer afford to do so. President Truman responded by asking Congress for aid to both countries and establishing what became known as the Truman Doctrine—a commitment to support free peoples resisting Communist takeover.

ANALYZE

What policy does Truman advocate in this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Harry S. Truman	WHEN? March 12, 1947	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Containment Policy
Política de Contención

CP
The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Marshall Plan
say: MAR-shul plan
Plan Marshall

MP
The massive U.S. program providing over \$13 billion in economic aid to rebuild Western European economies after World War II (1948-1952), designed to prevent communist expansion by fostering prosperity and...

Iron Curtain
say: EYE-ern KUR-tun
Cortina de Hierro

IC
Winston Churchill's metaphor for the political, military, and ideological barrier dividing Soviet-controlled Eastern Europe from Western Europe after World War II, symbolizing the split between communist and...

Truman Doctrine
say: TROO-mun DOK-trin
Doctrina Truman

TD
President Truman's 1947 policy pledging U.S. support for nations threatened by Soviet communism, beginning with military and economic aid to Greece and Turkey, marking America's commitment to containing communist...

NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)
OTAN (Organización del Tratado del Atlántico Norte)

N
The military alliance formed in 1949 by the United States, Canada, and Western European nations pledging mutual defense against Soviet aggression, embodying the principle that "an attack on one is an attack on all."

Warsaw Pact
say: WOR-saw pakt
Pacto de Varsovia

WP
The Soviet Union's military alliance formed in 1955 with communist Eastern European nations in response to NATO, creating two opposing military blocs that defined Cold War Europe.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Trace a policy in action

MODEL PROMPT: How did containment move from an idea to real programs?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The Truman Doctrine named the goal, the Marshall Plan funded recovery, and the Berlin Airlift proved U.S. resolve. Each step turned containment into action.

THINK ALOUD

List the Doctrine, Plan, and Airlift and label each 'words' or 'action.'

→ **Now you try:** *Pick the boldest containment move and defend your choice with evidence.*

Four Tools of Containment — Truman's Early Cold War Playbook

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Truman Doctrine speech excerpt and use your notes to build a timeline of four containment tools: the Long Telegram / containment idea, the Truman Doctrine (1947), the Marshall Plan (1948), and the Berlin Airlift (1948-49). For each, write one sentence on what it did and how it aimed to stop the spread of communism. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether containment was mainly a military or an economic strategy, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-step timeline (purpose + how it contained communism each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the nature of containment.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with the four tools pre-placed and a word bank of descriptions to match.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the Truman Doctrine to explain how the U.S. justified aiding distant nations as a defense of freedom everywhere.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us60-containment-early-cold-war.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-7/us60-containment-early-cold-war.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

The Marshall Plan (1948-1952) differed from the Truman Doctrine primarily in that —

- A** The Marshall Plan provided military equipment to threatened nations, while the Truman Doctrine offered only financial and advisory support.
- B** The Marshall Plan used economic aid to rebuild Western European economies, betting that prosperous, stable democracies would resist communist political movements.
- C** The Marshall Plan was offered to all European nations including the Soviet Union, while the Truman Doctrine explicitly excluded communist states from eligibility.
- D** The Marshall Plan was a multilateral program administered by the UN, while the Truman Doctrine was unilateral American policy.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The Marshall Plan (1948-1952) differed from the Truman Doctrine primarily in that —

- A** The Marshall Plan provided military equipment to threatened nations, while the Truman Doctrine offered only financial and advisory support.
- B** The Marshall Plan used economic aid to rebuild Western European economies, betting that prosperous, stable democracies would resist communist political movements. ✓
- C** The Marshall Plan was offered to all European nations including the Soviet Union, while the Truman Doctrine explicitly excluded communist states from eligibility.
- D** The Marshall Plan was a multilateral program administered by the UN, while the Truman Doctrine was unilateral American policy.

Correct answer: B. Why: The Marshall Plan used economic aid to rebuild Western European economies, betting that prosperous, stable democracies would resist communist political movements — an economic strategy to contain communism rather than military support. Choice A is wrong because it describes marshall Plan provided...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Long Telegram and Containment
- The Truman Doctrine
- The Marshall Plan
- The Berlin Airlift

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was containment a wise, restrained strategy or one that overcommitted the U.S. around the globe? Argue with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the policy of containment and describe at least two actions the U.S. took to carry it out.

STANDARD

US.61

Second Red Scare & McCarthyism

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare, including: Americans' attitudes toward McCarthyism, blacklisting, and Julius and Ethel Rosenberg.

I CAN

I can analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare, including Americans' attitudes toward McCarthyism, blacklisting, and the Rosenberg case.

Words you need before we read

■ Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

■ Truman Doctrine

En español: *Doctrina Truman*

WHAT IT MEANS

President Truman's 1947 policy pledging U.S. support for nations threatened by Soviet communism, beginning with military and economic aid to Greece and Turkey, marking America's commitment to containing communist...

■ Marshall Plan

En español: *Plan Marshall*

WHAT IT MEANS

The massive U.S. program providing over \$13 billion in economic aid to rebuild Western European economies after World War II (1948-1952), designed to prevent communist expansion by fostering prosperity and...

Check your understanding

Why was the Marshall Plan successful in rebuilding Europe and preventing communist expansion?

- A It provided only military assistance, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era
- B It invested over \$13 billion in European recovery, strengthening economies, creating American trade partners, and reducing the appeal of communism in struggling nations** ✓ KEY
- C It was a failure that weakened European economies, but the historical record tells a more complex story and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- D It focused only on Eastern European nations, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.60 What was the policy of containment?

2

US.60 Name one program or action that put containment into practice.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What term describes making reckless accusations of disloyalty without evidence?

✓ **ANSWER**

McCarthyism.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the early 1950s, a fear of hidden communists gripped the United States: neighbors informed on neighbors, careers were destroyed by accusation alone, and a single senator claimed to hold secret lists of traitors inside the government.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a nation is afraid, how do we tell the difference between real threats and a witch hunt, and what happens to freedom when fear takes over?

Factors Contributing to the Second Red Scare

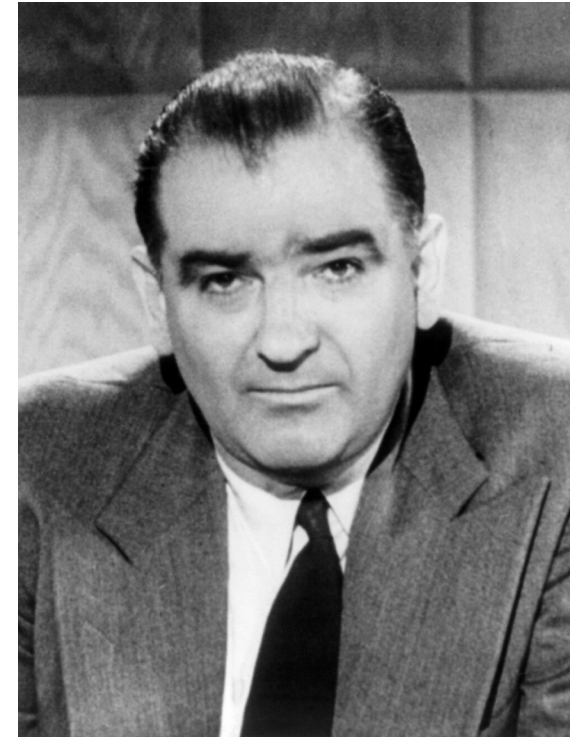
- Several events fueled American fears of communist infiltration: Soviet nuclear weapons development (1949), communist victory in China (1949), the Korean War (1950-53), and discovery of Soviet spy rings including the Rosenbergs and Alger Hiss.
- Senator Joseph McCarthy's accusations of communist infiltration in government intensified these fears into widespread paranoia.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Second Red Scare was caused by _____, and it affected Americans by _____.

McCarthyism

- Initially, many Americans supported McCarthy's anti-communist crusade due to genuine security fears.
- However, his reckless accusations, bullying tactics, and attack on the Army eventually turned public opinion against him.
- The 1954 Army-McCarthy hearings exposed his methods as destructive when attorney Joseph Welch famously asked, "Have you no sense of decency?"



United Press / U.S. Senate (public record portrait), c. 1954 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Blacklisting and Its Effects

- Hollywood studios blacklisted suspected communists, destroying careers of writers, directors, and actors.
- The "Hollywood Ten" were imprisoned for refusing to testify before HUAC (House Un-American Activities Committee).
- This created a climate of fear that stifled creative expression and political dissent across American society.

The Rosenberg Case

- Julius and Ethel Rosenberg were executed in 1953 for allegedly passing atomic secrets to the USSR.
- Their case became highly controversial—supporters claimed they were scapegoats, while others saw them as traitors.
- The case symbolized Cold War paranoia about internal communist threats and raised questions about justice during times of fear.



Roger Higgins, World Telegram staff photographer / New York World-Telegram and the Sun, 1951 [Library of Congress](#)

Key Figures

Senator Joseph McCarthy

U.S. Senator, Wisconsin (1908-1957)

- Claimed to hold lists of communists in the government
- Led sensational hearings that ruined reputations
- Was censured by the Senate in 1954 after overreaching

STRATEGY Use McCarthy to define McCarthyism from a real figure - accusation without evidence.

Julius & Ethel Rosenberg

Convicted of atomic espionage

- Accused of passing atomic secrets to the Soviet Union
- Convicted and executed in 1953 amid the Red Scare
- Their case fueled and reflected the fear of the era

STRATEGY Use the Rosenberg case to weigh real espionage fears against the era's excesses.

Wheeling Speech

Senator Joseph McCarthy • February 9, 1950

Close Reading

"I have here in my hand a list of 205—a list of names that were made known to the Secretary of State as being members of the Communist Party and who nevertheless are still working and shaping policy in the State Department... The reason why we find ourselves in a position of impotency is not because our only powerful potential enemy has sent men to invade our shores, but rather because of the traitorous actions of those who have been treated so well by this Nation."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Senator Joseph McCarthy delivered his famous speech in Wheeling, West Virginia in February 1950, claiming to have a list of known Communists working in the State Department. Coming just months after the Soviet Union tested its first atomic bomb and weeks after the conviction of spy Alger Hiss, his charges struck a nerve in a fearful nation. The era that followed—known as McCarthyism—saw thousands of Americans accused of Communist sympathies, often without evidence.

ANALYZE

What accusation does McCarthy make in this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? Senator Joseph McCarthy	WHEN? February 9, 1950	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [U.S. Senate Historical Office](#)

Word Wall

McCarthyism

Macartismo

say: *muh-KAR-thee-iz-um*

M

The practice of making accusations of subversion or treason without proper evidence, named after Senator Joseph McCarthy who led aggressive investigations of suspected communists in the 1950s.

HUAC (House Un-American Activities Committee)

HUAC (Comité de Actividades Antiamericanas)

H

A congressional committee established in 1938 to investigate alleged disloyalty and subversive activities, becoming especially aggressive in investigating suspected communists in the 1940s-1950s.

Julius and Ethel Rosenberg

Julius y Ethel Rosenberg

say: *JOOL-yus and ETH-ul ROH-zen-berg*

JA

An American couple convicted of espionage in 1951 for allegedly passing atomic secrets to the Soviet Union and executed in 1953, the only civilians executed for espionage during the Cold War.

Second Red Scare

Segundo Miedo Rojo

SR

The period of intense fear and persecution of suspected communists in America during the late 1940s and 1950s, driven by Cold War tensions and events like the Soviet atomic bomb and Korean War.

Blacklisting

Listas Negras

say: *BLAK-list-ing*

B

The practice of denying employment to people suspected of communist sympathies or refusing to cooperate with anti-communist investigations, particularly prevalent in the entertainment industry.

Containment Policy

Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Weigh evidence and fear

MODEL PROMPT: Was the Second Red Scare based on real threats, exaggeration, or both?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Real espionage (like the Rosenberg case) fed genuine fear, but McCarthy's baseless lists and blacklists went far beyond the evidence. Judge each claim against proof.

THINK ALOUD

Find one detail showing a real threat and one showing an excess.

→ **Now you try:** *Take a position on whether the Scare was justified, citing both.*

Fear on Trial — Anatomy of the Second Red Scare

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Senator McCarthy's Wheeling speech excerpt and study the McCarthy hearings photograph. Complete a four-part organizer: (1) the FACTORS that fueled the Second Red Scare; (2) how MCCARTHYISM worked and what tactics it used; (3) the effects of BLACKLISTING on ordinary Americans; (4) the ROSENBERG case and espionage fears. Add one detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on when fear of an enemy becomes a threat to a nation's own freedoms.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-part organizer (causes / McCarthyism / blacklisting / Rosenbergs, one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about fear and freedom.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the four parts pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Wheeling speech to analyze how McCarthy used unproven accusations to build political power.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us61-red-scare-mccarthyism.pdf](https://cornell-notes.com/unit-7/us61-red-scare-mccarthyism.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

During the Second Red Scare, McCarthyism damaged the careers of thousands of Americans. A political scientist argues that McCarthyism was more a symptom of institutional failure than of individual demagoguery. Which of the following pieces of evidence BEST supports this structural argument?

- A** McCarthy's uniquely persuasive speaking style allowed him to intimidate even experienced politicians into public silence and cooperation.
- B** HUAC had generated anti-communist blacklists before McCarthy's rise, and Hoover's FBI supplied unverified accusations — showing multiple institutions enabled the Red Scare.
- C** Soviet espionage successes like the Rosenberg atomic spy case provided strong evidence that McCarthy's general concerns were entirely valid.
- D** American fear of nuclear annihilation made the public uniquely vulnerable to McCarthy's demagoguery in ways not seen before in U.S. politics.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

During the Second Red Scare, McCarthyism damaged the careers of thousands of Americans. A political scientist argues that McCarthyism was more a symptom of institutional failure than of individual demagoguery. Which of the following pieces of evidence BEST supports this structural argument?

A McCarthy's uniquely persuasive speaking style allowed him to intimidate even experienced politicians into public silence and cooperation.

B HUAC had generated anti-communist blacklists before McCarthy's rise, and Hoover's FBI supplied unverified accusations — showing multiple institutions enabled the Red Scare. ✓

C Soviet espionage successes like the Rosenberg atomic spy case provided strong evidence that McCarthy's general concerns were entirely valid.

D American fear of nuclear annihilation made the public uniquely vulnerable to McCarthy's demagoguery in ways not seen before in U.S. politics.

Correct answer: B. Why: McCarthyism was enabled by institutional failures: the House Un-American Activities Committee (HUAC) had been conducting hearings and blacklists before McCarthy emerged; the FBI under Hoover actively supplied McCarthy with unverified information; and Congress, the press, and the legal system failed...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Factors Contributing to the Second Red Scare
- McCarthyism
- Blacklisting and Its Effects
- The Rosenberg Case

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Were the fears behind the Second Red Scare justified, or was it a dangerous overreaction?
Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Analyze the causes and effects of the Second Red Scare. What factors fueled it, and what were its consequences for Americans?

STANDARD

US.62

Korean War

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Korean War, including: Domino Theory, 38th parallel, Battle of Inchon, Entry of the communist Chinese, Final divisions of the Koreas.

I CAN

I can describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Korean War, including the Domino Theory, 38th parallel, Battle of Inchon, entry of communist China, and final divisions of the Koreas.

Words you need before we read

■ McCarthyism

En español: *Macartismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of making accusations of subversion or treason without proper evidence, named after Senator Joseph McCarthy who led aggressive investigations of suspected communists in the 1950s.

■ Second Red Scare

En español: *Segundo Miedo Rojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The period of intense fear and persecution of suspected communists in America during the late 1940s and 1950s, driven by Cold War tensions and events like the Soviet atomic bomb and Korean War.

■ Blacklisting

En español: *Listas Negras*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of denying employment to people suspected of communist sympathies or refusing to cooperate with anti-communist investigations, particularly prevalent in the entertainment industry.

Check your understanding

How did Senator Joseph McCarthy's tactics initially gain support but eventually backfire?

- A McCarthy never gained significant public support, which represents a common misconception about the period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- B McCarthy maintained support throughout his career, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- C His accusations resonated with genuine fears, but his bullying tactics and baseless attacks on the Army exposed his methods as reckless and destructive** ✓ KEY
- D His tactics were always viewed as inappropriate, but this fails to account for the broader historical context, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.61 What was the Second Red Scare?

2

US.61 What is McCarthyism?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What line divided North and South Korea?

✓ **ANSWER**

The 38th parallel.

COMMIT FIRST: have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.

Think About It

In 1950, communist North Korea poured across the 38th parallel into the South, and for the first time the United States sent troops to fight a hot war to stop the spread of communism, a war that would end almost exactly where it began.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why would the United States fight and lose tens of thousands of lives in a distant country, only to end the war where it started?

The Domino Theory and Its Application

- The domino theory held that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would follow like falling dominoes.
- Applied to Korea, it justified American intervention to prevent communist control of the entire peninsula and potential spread to Japan and Southeast Asia.
- This theory would later drive American involvement in Vietnam.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Korean War showed containment in action because _____, and it ended with _____.

Chinese Entry and Its Impact

- When UN forces under General MacArthur approached the Chinese border after the successful Inchon landing, China sent 300,000 "volunteers" into Korea.
- This dramatically changed the war's course, forcing UN retreat and extending the conflict.
- It demonstrated the limits of American power in Asia and the risks of overreach.

The 38th Parallel

- This line divided Korea after WWII, with the Soviet Union occupying the north and the U.S. the south.
- It became the invasion route when North Korea attacked South Korea in June 1950.
- After three years of fighting with over 36,000 American deaths, the armistice line roughly followed the original 38th parallel, showing the war's ultimate stalemate.

The Battle of Inchon

- MacArthur's surprise amphibious landing at Inchon (September 1950) cut off North Korean forces and nearly ended the war quickly.
- However, this success led to overconfidence, with MacArthur pushing toward China and triggering Chinese intervention that prolonged the conflict for two more years.



U.S. military / U.S. Federal Government, September 1950 [National Archives](#)

Key Figures

Harry S. Truman

33rd President; commander in chief in Korea

- Committed U.S. forces to defend South Korea in 1950
- Fought the war as a UN 'police action' to contain communism
- Fired Gen. MacArthur to keep the war limited

STRATEGY Use Truman's clash with MacArthur to show civilian control and the logic of limited war.

Gen. Douglas MacArthur

UN commander in Korea (1880-1964)

- Led the daring Inchon landing that reversed the war
- Pushed to expand the war into China
- Was removed by Truman for defying policy

STRATEGY Use MacArthur vs. Truman to argue over how far containment should go.

Address on the Korean War

Close Reading

President Harry S. Truman • April 11, 1951

"The Communists in the Kremlin are engaged in a monstrous conspiracy to stamp out freedom all over the world. If they were to succeed, the United States would be numbered among their principal victims. It must be clear to everyone that the United States cannot—and will not—sit idly by and await foreign conquest."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The Korean War began in June 1950 when Communist North Korea invaded South Korea. The United States, leading a United Nations coalition, intervened to defend South Korea. By late 1950, after American forces nearly reached the Chinese border, China entered the war, pushing the UN forces back. The war eventually settled into a bloody stalemate near the original border, raising difficult questions about America's Cold War strategy and the limits of military force.

ANALYZE

How does Truman justify American involvement in Korea?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Harry S. Truman	WHEN? April 11, 1951	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	--------------------------------	--

Source: [Harry S. Truman Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Korean War

Guerra de Corea

KW

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Domino Theory

Teoría del Dominó

say: DOM-ih-noh THEER-ee

DT

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Proxy War

Guerra por Poder

PW

Conflicts where the United States and Soviet Union supported opposing sides without directly fighting each other, allowing superpower competition while avoiding nuclear war.

Containment Policy

Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Superpower

Superpotencia

S

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)

OTAN (Organización del Tratado del Atlántico Norte)

N

The military alliance formed in 1949 by the United States, Canada, and Western European nations pledging mutual defense against Soviet aggression, embodying the principle that "an attack on one is an attack on all."

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Explain a limited war

MODEL PROMPT: Why did Truman keep the Korean War 'limited' and fire MacArthur?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Truman wanted to contain communism without triggering WWII with China or the USSR. MacArthur wanted to widen the war, so Truman removed him to keep civilian control.

THINK ALOUD

Underline the reason Truman gave for limiting the war.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain whether Truman or MacArthur had the stronger case, citing the text.*

The First Hot War of the Cold War — Korea

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Truman's Address on the Korean War and review the Battle of Inchon photograph. Build a chart tracking four elements: the DOMINO THEORY behind U.S. intervention, CHINESE ENTRY and its impact, the 38TH PARALLEL as a dividing line, and the BATTLE OF INCHON as a turning point. Write one sentence on the significance of each. Finish with a one-sentence claim on why the Korean War is often called a 'stalemate' or 'forgotten war,' supported by evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-element chart (one-sentence significance each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the war's outcome.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four elements pre-labeled and a word bank of details to place. Honors: Write a paragraph using Truman's address to explain how containment turned a civil war in Korea into a U.S. military commitment.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us62-korean-war.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

The Battle of Inchon (September 1950) is considered one of the most daring amphibious operations of the twentieth century. Which of the following BEST explains why the Inchon landing was strategically significant beyond its immediate military success?

- A** The Inchon landing demonstrated that amphibious warfare was superior to conventional ground assault, fundamentally changing U.S. military doctrine for future conflicts.
- B** The Inchon landing convinced China that the United States planned to invade the Chinese mainland, directly triggering Chinese entry into the Korean War.
- C** The success at Inchon persuaded the Soviet Union to withdraw its military advisors from North Korea, reducing the risk of direct superpower confrontation.
- D** Inchon's success emboldened the advance past the 38th parallel toward China's border, triggering Chinese intervention and transforming a containment success into a far more costly conflict.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The Battle of Inchon (September 1950) is considered one of the most daring amphibious operations of the twentieth century. Which of the following BEST explains why the Inchon landing was strategically significant beyond its immediate military success?

- A** The Inchon landing demonstrated that amphibious warfare was superior to conventional ground assault, fundamentally changing U.S. military doctrine for future conflicts.
- B** The Inchon landing convinced China that the United States planned to invade the Chinese mainland, directly triggering Chinese entry into the Korean War.
- C** The success at Inchon persuaded the Soviet Union to withdraw its military advisors from North Korea, reducing the risk of direct superpower confrontation.
- D** Inchon's success emboldened the advance past the 38th parallel toward China's border, triggering Chinese intervention and transforming a containment success into a far more costly conflict. ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: The Inchon landing reversed the military situation in Korea dramatically: UN forces had been pushed into the Pusan Perimeter, and the landing cut North Korean supply lines and forced a rapid retreat northward, liberating Seoul. Its broader strategic significance was that it reinforced MacArthur's...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Domino Theory and Its Application
- Chinese Entry and Its Impact
- The 38th Parallel
- The Battle of Inchon

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the Korean War a success or a failure for U.S. containment policy? Argue your position with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Analyze how the Korean War reflected the Cold War policy of containment, including its causes, course, and outcome.

STANDARD

US.63

Eisenhower's Cold War Policies

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain Cold War policies during President Dwight D. Eisenhower's administration, including brinkmanship and "peaceful coexistence".

I CAN

I can explain Cold War policies during President Eisenhower's administration, including brinkmanship and "peaceful coexistence."

Words you need before we read

Korean War

En español: *Guerra de Corea*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Check your understanding

Why did Chinese entry into the Korean War change the conflict's course and duration?

- A** Chinese involvement had no significant impact, but the historical record tells a more complex story
- B** China supported UN forces against North Korea, but the historical record tells a more complex story
- C** Chinese entry quickly ended the war, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work
- D** China's 300,000 troops forced UN retreat, transformed a near-victory into stalemate, and extended the war by two years ✓ **KEY**

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.62 What was the Domino Theory?

2

US.62 How did the Korean War end?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Which WWII general became president and led the U.S. through much of the 1950s Cold War?

✓ **ANSWER**

Dwight D. Eisenhower.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

President Eisenhower, the general who had won World War II, now led the nation through the most dangerous years of the Cold War, threatening 'massive retaliation' with nuclear weapons while quietly warning Americans against the dangers of a permanent 'military-industrial complex.'

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How does a leader keep the peace by threatening total war, and what did Eisenhower fear even his own nation was becoming?

Brinkmanship

- Secretary of State John Foster Dulles advocated pushing dangerous situations to the brink of war to force opponents to back down.
- This strategy relied on nuclear deterrence and superior American resolve.
- Applied during the Suez Crisis (1956) and Berlin Crisis (1958), brinkmanship assumed that the threat of nuclear war would make enemies capitulate.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Eisenhower used brinkmanship to _____, but he also warned Americans about _____.



White House / U.S. Federal Government, May 29, 1959 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Peaceful Coexistence

- This concept, promoted by Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev after Stalin's death, suggested that capitalist and communist nations could coexist without war while competing economically and ideologically.
- It represented a shift from Stalin's more aggressive approach and opened possibilities for diplomacy while maintaining fundamental competition.

Comparing Approaches

- Brinkmanship was an aggressive, risk-taking approach using the threat of nuclear war to achieve goals.
- Peaceful coexistence was a more diplomatic approach emphasizing competition over confrontation.
- Both sought to avoid actual nuclear war while maintaining ideological competition—brinkmanship through deterrence, peaceful coexistence through negotiation.

Key Figure

Dwight D. Eisenhower

34th President (1953-1961)

- Adopted the 'New Look' relying on nuclear deterrence
- Used brinkmanship and the CIA to fight the Cold War cheaply
- Warned in his farewell of the 'military-industrial complex'

STRATEGY Use Eisenhower to show a general-turned-president managing Cold War risk and cost.

Eisenhower's "New Look" Policy Speech

Close Reading

President Dwight D. Eisenhower • January 12, 1954

"The basic decision was to depend primarily upon a great capacity to retaliate, instantly, by means and at places of our choosing... The way to deter aggression is for the free community to be willing and able to respond vigorously at places and with means of its own choosing."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

President Eisenhower came to office in 1953 facing a difficult strategic problem: maintaining American security against the Soviet threat while cutting the enormous military budgets of the Korean War era. His answer was the 'New Look' defense policy—relying more heavily on nuclear weapons and air power (which were cheaper than large conventional armies) and using the threat of 'massive retaliation' against Soviet aggression to deter attacks.

ANALYZE

What military strategy does Eisenhower describe in this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Dwight D. Eisenhower	WHEN? January 12, 1954	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	---	----------------------------------	--

Source: [Dwight D. Eisenhower Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Brinkmanship

Política al Borde del Abismo

say: BRINGK-mun-ship

B

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

Eisenhower Doctrine

Doctrina Eisenhower

ED

President Eisenhower's 1957 policy pledging U.S. military and economic aid to Middle Eastern countries resisting communist aggression, extending containment policy to protect oil supplies and strategic interests.

Military-Industrial Complex

Complejo Militar-Industrial

say: MIL-ih-tair-ee in-DUS-tree-ul KOM-pleks

MC

The close relationship between the military, defense contractors, and government that President Eisenhower warned about in 1961, concerned that this alliance could drive unnecessary military spending and influence...

Domino Theory

Teoría del Dominó

say: DOM-ih-noh THEER-ee

DT

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Warsaw Pact

Pacto de Varsovia

say: WOR-saw pakt

WP

The Soviet Union's military alliance formed in 1955 with communist Eastern European nations in response to NATO, creating two opposing military blocs that defined Cold War Europe.

Interstate Highway System

Sistema de Autopistas Interestatales

IH

The massive network of limited-access highways authorized by President Eisenhower in 1956, connecting American cities and transforming transportation, commerce, and development patterns.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze a strategy

MODEL PROMPT: How did Eisenhower fight the Cold War more cheaply?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The 'New Look' leaned on nuclear deterrence, alliances, and the CIA instead of large armies. Brinkmanship threatened massive retaliation to deter the Soviets at lower cost.

THINK ALOUD

Circle one tool of the 'New Look' named in the source.

→ Now you try: *Explain one risk of relying on nuclear threats, citing the text.*

Peace Through Fear — Eisenhower's Cold War Balance

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Eisenhower's 'New Look' policy speech and use your notes to compare two approaches in a two-column chart: BRINKMANSHIP (massive retaliation, threat of nuclear force) and PEACEFUL COEXISTENCE (diplomacy, avoiding direct war). List at least two features of each. Then note one event that shows each approach in action. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how Eisenhower tried to hold these opposite strategies together, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-approach chart (2+ features + one event each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about Eisenhower's balancing act.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart pre-labeled 'Brinkmanship' and 'Peaceful Coexistence' with a word bank to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the 'New Look' speech to argue whether threatening nuclear war made the world safer or more dangerous.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us63-eisenhower-cold-war-policies.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

Eisenhower's farewell address warned of the 'military-industrial complex.' Which of the following MOST accurately explains the internal tension between this warning and Eisenhower's own defense policies during his presidency?

- A** Eisenhower's farewell address was purely rhetorical because he never actually spent significant money on defense during his presidency.
- B** There was no real tension because Eisenhower's 'New Look' policy reduced overall defense spending, making his warning about the military-industrial complex prophetic rather than self-contradictory.
- C** Eisenhower's 'New Look' policy actually expanded the nuclear and aerospace defense industries, meaning he contributed to building the very military-industrial complex he warned against in his farewell address.
- D** Eisenhower directed his warning specifically at his successor Kennedy, whose proposed conventional military buildup he feared would enrich weapons manufacturers.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

Eisenhower's farewell address warned of the 'military-industrial complex.' Which of the following **MOST** accurately explains the internal tension between this warning and Eisenhower's own defense policies during his presidency?

- A** Eisenhower's farewell address was purely rhetorical because he never actually spent significant money on defense during his presidency.
- B** There was no real tension because Eisenhower's 'New Look' policy reduced overall defense spending, making his warning about the military-industrial complex prophetic rather than self-contradictory.
- C** Eisenhower's 'New Look' policy actually expanded the nuclear and aerospace defense industries, meaning he contributed to building the very military-industrial complex he warned against in his farewell address. ✓
- D** Eisenhower directed his warning specifically at his successor Kennedy, whose proposed conventional military buildup he feared would enrich weapons manufacturers.

Correct answer: C. Why: Eisenhower's warning was ironic because his own 'New Look' policy, which emphasized nuclear weapons and airpower over conventional forces, significantly expanded the defense industry and the influence of weapons contractors. By choosing massive retaliation over conventional defense, Eisenhower...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Brinkmanship
- Peaceful Coexistence
- Comparing Approaches

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did Eisenhower's mix of brinkmanship and coexistence make the world safer or more dangerous? Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Analyze Eisenhower's Cold War policies. How did brinkmanship and 'peaceful coexistence' shape his approach, and what tensions existed between them?

STANDARD

US.64

Nuclear Fears and Civil Defense

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the fears of Americans surrounding nuclear holocaust and debates over stockpiling and the use of nuclear weapons, including: Atomic testing, Civil defense, Fallout shelters, Impact of Sputnik, Mutual assured destruction.

I CAN

I can explain the fears of Americans surrounding nuclear holocaust and debates over stockpiling and the use of nuclear weapons, including atomic testing, civil defense, fallout shelters, Sputnik, and mutual assured destruction.

Words you need before we read

■ Brinkmanship

En español: *Política al Borde del Abismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

■ Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

■ Eisenhower Doctrine

En español: *Doctrina Eisenhower*

WHAT IT MEANS

President Eisenhower's 1957 policy pledging U.S. military and economic aid to Middle Eastern countries resisting communist aggression, extending containment policy to protect oil supplies and strategic interests.

Check your understanding

Compare brinkmanship and peaceful coexistence as Cold War strategies.

A Brinkmanship used nuclear threats aggressively while peaceful coexistence emphasized diplomatic competition—both aimed to avoid actual war while continuing ideological struggle

✓ KEY

B Both strategies were identical in approach, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic

C Neither strategy addressed nuclear weapons, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality

D Peaceful coexistence was more aggressive than brinkmanship, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.63 What was Eisenhower's policy of brinkmanship?

2

US.63 What did Eisenhower warn about in his farewell address?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What nuclear-attack drill did American schoolchildren practice in the Cold War?

✓ **ANSWER**

'Duck and cover.'

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

American schoolchildren practiced 'duck and cover' drills under their desks, families built backyard fallout shelters, and a single Soviet satellite beeping overhead convinced millions that the enemy might soon rain nuclear fire from space.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did the constant threat of nuclear annihilation reshape the everyday lives, fears, and choices of ordinary Americans?

American Fears of Nuclear Holocaust

- Americans lived with constant anxiety about nuclear attack.
- "Duck and cover" drills in schools, fallout shelter construction, and civil defense programs reflected deep fears about nuclear annihilation.
- Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD) paradoxically provided security through the promise of mutual annihilation—neither side would attack knowing both would be destroyed.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

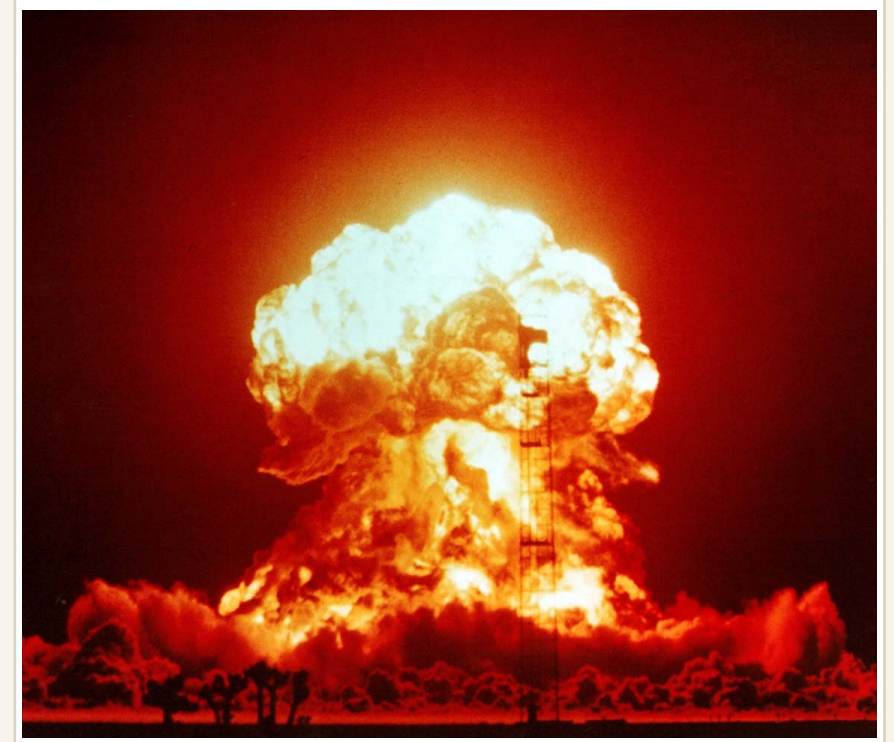
The threat of nuclear war changed American life by _____, for example _____.

Debates Over Nuclear Stockpiling

- Hawks argued for nuclear superiority to deter Soviet aggression, while doves worried about accidental war and escalating arms race costs.
- The debate intensified with hydrogen bomb development and ICBM deployment.
- Some questioned whether building more weapons enhanced security or simply increased the risk of catastrophic accident.

Atomic Testing Impact

- Above-ground nuclear tests created public health concerns about radioactive fallout.
- The 1954 Bravo test contaminated Japanese fishermen and Pacific islanders, increasing international pressure for test bans and raising awareness of nuclear weapons' environmental dangers.
- These concerns eventually led to the Limited Test Ban Treaty of 1963.



National Nuclear Security Administration / Nevada Site Office / U.S. Federal Government, April 18, 1953 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Sputnik's Significance

- The 1957 Soviet satellite launch shocked Americans, suggesting Soviet technological superiority and ICBM capability.
- If the Soviets could launch a satellite, they could deliver nuclear warheads to American cities.
- This intensified the space race, led to increased science education funding through the National Defense Education Act, and created fears about American vulnerability.

Key Figure

The American Family, 1950s

Postwar suburban households

- Practiced 'duck and cover' drills and built fallout shelters
- Rode the baby boom, G.I. Bill, and suburban growth
- Lived with both prosperity and nuclear dread

STRATEGY Keep it concrete: one family, one shelter, one new suburban home.

Civil Defense Pamphlet

Federal Civil Defense Administration • 1951

Close Reading

"You can survive an atomic bomb attack! But you must know what to do. Duck and cover at the flash of light. Stay away from windows. If outdoors, lie flat on the ground. Have an emergency kit ready. Build a fallout shelter in your basement or backyard. With proper preparation, you and your family can survive."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

During the Cold War, the U.S. government created extensive civil defense programs to prepare the public for a potential nuclear attack. Duck-and-cover drills in schools, bomb shelter construction guides, and government pamphlets on nuclear survival became part of everyday American life in the 1950s. While these measures provided false security against the actual effects of nuclear weapons, they reflected genuine fear of Soviet nuclear attack and served to keep Americans informed about—and supportive of—Cold War policies.

ANALYZE

What does this pamphlet reveal about American attitudes toward nuclear war in the 1950s?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Federal Civil Defense Administration	1951	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Nuclear Fears

Miedos Nucleares

NF

The widespread anxiety in 1950s America about nuclear war with the Soviet Union, driven by atomic bomb tests, the arms race, and fear of sudden nuclear annihilation.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

Destrucción Mutua Asegurada

MA

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

G.I. Bill

Ley G.I.

GB

The Servicemen's Readjustment Act of 1944 that provided World War II veterans with benefits including college tuition, low-interest home loans, and unemployment benefits, transforming American society.

Fallout Shelters

Refugios Antibombas

FS

Underground or reinforced structures designed to protect people from radioactive fallout after a nuclear explosion, widely promoted and built during the 1950s as Cold War tensions escalated.

Baby Boom

Baby Boom

BB

The dramatic increase in birth rates from 1946-1964, with 76 million babies born in the U.S., as returning World War II veterans started families in prosperous post-war America.

Growth of Suburbia

Crecimiento de los Suburbios

GO

The explosive expansion of residential communities outside city centers during the 1950s, enabled by highways, affordable housing, and the desire for space and safety.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Connect fear and society

MODEL PROMPT: How did nuclear fear shape everyday American life in the 1950s?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Families practiced 'duck and cover' and built fallout shelters even as they enjoyed suburbs, cars, and TV. Prosperity and dread grew side by side.

THINK ALOUD

List one sign of fear and one sign of prosperity from the section.

→ Now you try: *Explain how both could exist at once, citing the text.*

Duck and Cover — Living With the Bomb

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Study the Civil Defense pamphlet excerpt and the atomic-test photograph. Complete a four-part organizer: (1) the FEARS Americans felt about nuclear holocaust; (2) the DEBATES over stockpiling and using nuclear weapons; (3) the IMPACT of atomic testing; (4) how SPUTNIK deepened these fears. Add one detail per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on how nuclear fear reshaped everyday American life in the 1950s.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-part organizer (fears / stockpiling debate / testing impact / Sputnik, one detail each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about nuclear fear in daily life.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the four parts pre-labeled and a fact bank to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Civil Defense pamphlet to analyze how the government tried to calm, and also to prepare, a frightened public.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us64-nuclear-fears-civil-defense.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did civil defense programs reflect Cold War anxieties?

- A** It expanded the war without congressional knowledge and violated Cambodian neutrality.
- B** Soviet satellite launch in 1957 that shocked Americans and intensified the space race.
- C** "Duck and cover" drills and fallout shelters showed pervasive fear of nuclear attack.
- D** Teach children to protect themselves from nuclear blast, though with limited effect.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did civil defense programs reflect Cold War anxieties?

- A** It expanded the war without congressional knowledge and violated Cambodian neutrality.
- B** Soviet satellite launch in 1957 that shocked Americans and intensified the space race.
- C** "Duck and cover" drills and fallout shelters showed pervasive fear of nuclear attack. ✓
- D** Teach children to protect themselves from nuclear blast, though with limited effect.

Correct answer: C. **Why:** civil defense programs reflect Cold War anxieties because "Duck and cover" drills and fallout shelters showed pervasive fear of nuclear attack. Choice D is wrong because it describes teach children to protect themselves from nuclear blast, though with limited effect, not "Duck and cover" drills and...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- American Fears of Nuclear Holocaust
- Debates Over Nuclear Stockpiling
- Atomic Testing Impact
- Sputnik's Significance

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did Cold War civil-defense measures genuinely protect Americans, or mainly manage their fear?
Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe how the threat of nuclear war affected life in Cold War America. Give at least two specific examples.

STANDARD

US.65

U.S.-Cuba Relations

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the relationship between Cuba and the U.S., including the Bay of Pigs Invasion and Cuban Missile Crisis.

I CAN

I can describe the relationship between Cuba and the U.S., including the Bay of Pigs Invasion and Cuban Missile Crisis.

Words you need before we read

Nuclear Fears

En español: *Miedos Nucleares*

WHAT IT MEANS

The widespread anxiety in 1950s America about nuclear war with the Soviet Union, driven by atomic bomb tests, the arms race, and fear of sudden nuclear annihilation.

Fallout Shelters

En español: *Refugios Antibombas*

WHAT IT MEANS

Underground or reinforced structures designed to protect people from radioactive fallout after a nuclear explosion, widely promoted and built during the 1950s as Cold War tensions escalated.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

En español: *Destrucción Mutua Asegurada*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Check your understanding

Why did Sputnik shock Americans and change U.S. education and defense policies?

- A Sputnik had no significant impact on American policy, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B It demonstrated Soviet technological capability and potential ICBM threat, spurring the space race, increased science education funding, and heightened fears of nuclear vulnerability ✓ KEY**
- C Americans celebrated Soviet space achievements, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- D Sputnik only affected the space program, not other policies, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.64 What was 'duck and cover,' and what did it reveal about the era?

2

US.64 Why did the launch of Sputnik alarm the United States in 1957?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What 1962 standoff brought the U.S. and USSR closest to nuclear war?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Cuban Missile Crisis.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

For thirteen days in October 1962, the world stood closer to nuclear war than ever before or since, as American spy planes photographed Soviet missiles ninety miles from Florida and two superpowers stared each other down over the island of Cuba.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When the fate of the world hangs on a single decision, how do leaders step back from the brink, and what did the Cuban Missile Crisis teach both sides?

Historical Background

- The U.S. had dominated Cuba economically since the Spanish-American War of 1898, supporting dictator Fulgencio Batista.
- Fidel Castro's 1959 revolution initially received mixed American reaction, but his communist alignment, property nationalization, and alliance with the Soviet Union quickly soured relations and created a Cold War flashpoint 90 miles from Florida.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

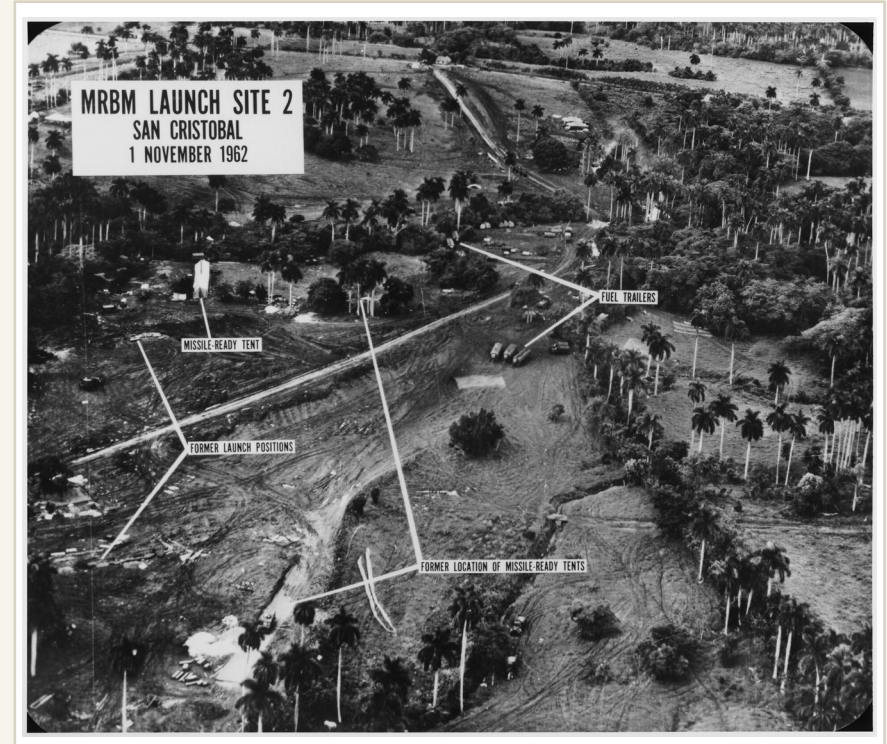
The Cuban Missile Crisis began when _____, and it was resolved when _____.

The Bay of Pigs Invasion

- The CIA-planned 1961 invasion used Cuban exiles to overthrow Castro.
- The operation failed disastrously when President Kennedy withdrew air support at the last moment, leaving the invasion force stranded on the beach.
- This humiliating failure embarrassed the U.S. internationally and pushed Castro closer to the Soviet Union for protection.

The Cuban Missile Crisis

- In October 1962, Soviet missiles discovered in Cuba brought the world to the brink of nuclear war.
- For thirteen days, Kennedy and Khrushchev engaged in the most dangerous confrontation of the Cold War.
- Kennedy's naval quarantine and secret negotiations led to Soviet withdrawal in exchange for U.S. promises not to invade Cuba and quietly remove missiles from Turkey.



U.S. Air Force / Central Intelligence Agency reconnaissance; National Archives and Records Administration, October 1962 [National Archives](#)

Crisis Resolution and Aftermath

- The Cuban Missile Crisis demonstrated brinkmanship's dangers and led to improved U.S.-Soviet communication, including a direct "hotline" between Washington and Moscow.
- Both sides, having stared into nuclear abyss, became more cautious about direct confrontation while continuing competition through other means.

Key Figures

John F. Kennedy

35th President (1961-1963)

- Faced the failed Bay of Pigs invasion of Cuba
- Confronted Soviet missiles in Cuba in October 1962
- Chose a naval quarantine over an invasion, avoiding nuclear war

STRATEGY Use JFK to show a president managing the closest brush with nuclear war.

Nikita Khrushchev

Soviet Premier (1894-1971)

- Placed nuclear missiles in Cuba in 1962
- Negotiated their removal with Kennedy to end the crisis
- Agreed to a hotline to reduce future risk

STRATEGY Pair Khrushchev with JFK so students see the crisis as two leaders stepping back from the brink.

Cuban Missile Crisis Address

President John F. Kennedy • October 22, 1962

Argumentation

"Within the past week, unmistakable evidence has established the fact that a series of offensive missile sites is now in preparation on that imprisoned island. The purpose of these bases can be none other than to provide a nuclear strike capability against the Western Hemisphere... It shall be the policy of this Nation to regard any nuclear missile launched from Cuba against any nation in the Western Hemisphere as an attack by the Soviet Union on the United States, requiring a full retaliatory response upon the Soviet Union."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In October 1962, American spy planes discovered Soviet nuclear missile installations being built in Cuba—just 90 miles from Florida. For 13 days, the world stood on the brink of nuclear war as President Kennedy demanded the Soviets remove the missiles. Kennedy chose a naval blockade rather than airstrikes, giving Soviet leader Khrushchev time to back down. The crisis ended when the Soviets agreed to remove the missiles in exchange for an American pledge not to invade Cuba and a secret agreement to remove American missiles from Turkey.

ANALYZE

What warning does Kennedy issue to the Soviet Union?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President John F. Kennedy	WHEN? October 22, 1962	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	----------------------------------	--

Source: [John F. Kennedy Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Cuban Missile Crisis

Cuban Missile Crisis

say: KYOO-bun MIS-ul KRY-sis

CM

The thirteen-day 1962 confrontation between the United States and the Soviet Union over Soviet nuclear missiles installed in Cuba, widely regarded as the closest the Cold War came to full-scale nuclear war.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

Destrucción Mutua Asegurada

MA

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Nuclear Fears

Miedos Nucleares

NF

The widespread anxiety in 1950s America about nuclear war with the Soviet Union, driven by atomic bomb tests, the arms race, and fear of sudden nuclear annihilation.

Brinkmanship

Política al Borde del Abismo

say: BRINGK-mun-ship

B

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

Containment Policy

Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Superpower

Superpotencia

S

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Build an argument

MODEL PROMPT: Did Kennedy handle the Cuban Missile Crisis wisely? What does the evidence show?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

JFK chose a naval quarantine over an invasion, giving Khrushchev room to remove the missiles without war. Weigh the risk of firmness against the risk of backing down.

THINK ALOUD

Find one line showing Kennedy's firmness and one showing restraint.

→ **Now you try:** *State whether his choice was wise and support it with a quote.*

Thirteen Days on the Brink — The U.S. and Cuba

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read President Kennedy's Cuban Missile Crisis Address and review the U-2 reconnaissance photograph. Build a chart tracking four moments: the HISTORICAL BACKGROUND of U.S.-Cuba relations, the BAY OF PIGS invasion, the CUBAN MISSILE CRISIS itself, and the RESOLUTION and aftermath (naval quarantine, missile removal, hotline). Write one sentence on the significance of each. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how the crisis was resolved without war, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-moment chart (one-sentence significance each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about how nuclear war was avoided.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four moments pre-labeled and a word bank of details to place. Honors: Write a paragraph using Kennedy's address to argue whether the naval 'quarantine' was a wise middle path between doing nothing and launching an attack.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us65-us-cuba-relations.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

The Bay of Pigs invasion (April 1961) failed militarily and damaged U.S. credibility internationally. Which COMBINATION of factors MOST explains the strategic magnitude of the failure?

- A** The Cuban exile brigade was too small and lacked sufficient military training, making failure inevitable regardless of the air support or uprising assumptions.
- B** Soviet intelligence had warned Castro about the invasion plan months in advance, allowing Cuba to prepare a defense that U.S. planners had not anticipated.
- C** Kennedy cancelled the planned air strikes and the CIA's false assumption of a popular uprising proved wrong — removing both the military and political foundations of the operation simultaneously.
- D** The UN Security Council condemned the invasion before it began, stripping the operation of international legitimacy and leading Kennedy to suspend the military operation.

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The Bay of Pigs invasion (April 1961) failed militarily and damaged U.S. credibility internationally. Which COMBINATION of factors MOST explains the strategic magnitude of the failure?

- A** The Cuban exile brigade was too small and lacked sufficient military training, making failure inevitable regardless of the air support or uprising assumptions.
- B** Soviet intelligence had warned Castro about the invasion plan months in advance, allowing Cuba to prepare a defense that U.S. planners had not anticipated.
- C** Kennedy cancelled the planned air strikes and the CIA's false assumption of a popular uprising proved wrong — removing both the military and political foundations of the operation simultaneously. ✓
- D** The UN Security Council condemned the invasion before it began, stripping the operation of international legitimacy and leading Kennedy to suspend the military operation.

Correct answer: C. Why: The Bay of Pigs failure had multiple compounding factors: Kennedy canceled the planned air strikes that would have neutralized Castro's air force, leaving the invasion force without air cover; the plan assumed a popular uprising that never materialized because Cubans did not rise against Castro...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Historical Background
- The Bay of Pigs Invasion
- The Cuban Missile Crisis
- Crisis Resolution and Aftermath

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Whose handling of the Cuban Missile Crisis, Kennedy's or Khrushchev's, better served the world?
Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Analyze the Cuban Missile Crisis. What caused it, how was it resolved, and why is it considered so significant?

STANDARD

US.66

Vietnam War Causes, Course, and Consequences

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Vietnam War, including: Geneva Accords, Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Tet Offensive, Ho Chi Minh, Bombing of Cambodia, Napalm and Agent Orange, Vietnamization.

I CAN

I can describe the causes, course, and consequences of the Vietnam War, including the Geneva Accords, Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Tet Offensive, Ho Chi Minh, bombing of Cambodia, napalm and Agent Orange, and Vietnamization.

Words you need before we read

Cuban Missile Crisis

En español: *Cuban Missile Crisis*

WHAT IT MEANS

The thirteen-day 1962 confrontation between the United States and the Soviet Union over Soviet nuclear missiles installed in Cuba, widely regarded as the closest the Cold War came to full-scale nuclear war.

Brinkmanship

En español: *Política al Borde del Abismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War diplomatic strategy of pushing dangerous situations to the edge of war to force the other side to back down, associated with Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in the 1950s.

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

En español: *Destrucción Mutua Asegurada*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Check your understanding

Why did the Bay of Pigs invasion fail and what were its consequences?

- A The invasion succeeded in overthrowing Castro, but this fails to account for the broader historical context
- B The invasion was never actually attempted, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- C Kennedy's withdrawal of air support doomed the invasion, humiliating the U.S. and pushing Castro closer to Soviet protection** ✓ KEY
- D The failure had no long-term consequences, which does not align with the documented historical record

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.65 What was the Cuban Missile Crisis?

2

US.65 How was the Cuban Missile Crisis resolved?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What Southeast Asian war became the longest, most divisive of the era?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Vietnam War.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

What began as a small commitment of advisers in a faraway jungle grew into a war that killed more than 58,000 Americans, divided the nation, and ended without the victory that had been promised, all in the name of stopping communism.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did the United States become trapped in the longest, most divisive war of its century, and why did the world's most powerful military fail to win it?

The Geneva Accords

- The 1954 Geneva Accords temporarily divided Vietnam at the 17th parallel after French defeat at Dien Bien Phu.
- Elections were planned for 1956 to reunify the country.
- When South Vietnam, with American support, refused elections (fearing Ho Chi Minh would win), the division became permanent, setting the stage for decades of conflict.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Vietnam War was caused by _____, escalated after _____, and resulted in _____.

Ho Chi Minh's Role

- Ho Chi Minh led Vietnamese independence movements against French colonial rule and later American intervention.
- His nationalist-communist ideology appealed to many Vietnamese seeking independence and unification.
- To North Vietnamese, he was a liberator; to Americans, he represented communist expansion that must be contained.

The Gulf of Tonkin Resolution

- Following alleged attacks on U.S. destroyers in August 1964, Congress authorized President Johnson to use military force in Vietnam.
- This resolution effectively gave Johnson a blank check for escalation without a formal war declaration.
- Later evidence suggested the attacks were exaggerated or misrepresented.

The Tet Offensive

- The 1968 coordinated North Vietnamese attack on South Vietnamese cities during the Tet holiday militarily failed but psychologically succeeded.
- Television coverage showed the war's brutality and contradicted official claims of progress, turning American public opinion against the war and contributing to Johnson's decision not to seek reelection.



U.S. Army / U.S. Federal Government, c. 1966–1968 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Chemical Weapons and Vietnamization

- Napalm and Agent Orange caused immediate casualties and long-term environmental damage.
- Agent Orange's health effects on veterans and Vietnamese civilians created lasting controversy.
- Nixon's Vietnamization policy gradually transferred fighting responsibility to South Vietnamese forces while withdrawing American troops, aiming to end American involvement while maintaining South Vietnam.

Key Figures

Lyndon B. Johnson

36th President; escalated in Vietnam

- Used the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution to widen the war
- Sent hundreds of thousands of U.S. troops to Vietnam
- Saw the war undermine his Great Society and presidency

STRATEGY Use LBJ to show how containment logic pulled the U.S. deeper into Vietnam.

Ho Chi Minh

North Vietnamese leader (1890-1969)

- Led the communist fight for a unified Vietnam
- Framed the war as anti-colonial independence
- Outlasted U.S. escalation through persistence

STRATEGY Use Ho Chi Minh to show the U.S. faced nationalism, not just communism.

Gulf of Tonkin Resolution

Close Reading

U.S. Congress • August 7, 1964

"The Congress approves and supports the determination of the President, as Commander in Chief, to take all necessary measures to repel any armed attack against the forces of the United States and to prevent further aggression... The United States is, therefore, prepared, as the President determines, to take all necessary steps, including the use of armed force."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In August 1964, President Johnson reported that North Vietnamese torpedo boats had attacked U.S. destroyers in the Gulf of Tonkin. Congress passed the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, giving Johnson broad authority to escalate American military involvement in Vietnam. Later investigations revealed that the second 'attack' on August 4 almost certainly never occurred, and that the resolution was used to justify a massive escalation that eventually brought over 500,000 American troops to Vietnam.

ANALYZE

What authority did the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution grant to the President?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? U.S. Congress	WHEN? August 7, 1964	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Korean War
Guerra de Corea

KW

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Containment Policy
Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Communism
Comunismo
say: KOM-yoo-niz-um

C

A political and economic system where the government owns all property and means of production, theoretically distributing resources equally, practiced in the Soviet Union and opposed by the United States during...

Domino Theory
Teoría del Dominó
say: DOM-ih-noh THEER-ee

DT

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Proxy War
Guerra por Poder

PW

Conflicts where the United States and Soviet Union supported opposing sides without directly fighting each other, allowing superpower competition while avoiding nuclear war.

Cold War
Guerra Fría
say: kohld wor

CW

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Sort cause and consequence

MODEL PROMPT: Why did the U.S. fight in Vietnam, and what did it cost?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Containment and the domino theory drew the U.S. in; the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution widened the war. The cost was heavy casualties, division at home, and eventual withdrawal.

THINK ALOUD

Underline one cause and one consequence of the war.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain which consequence you think mattered most, citing the text.*

How America Went to War in Vietnam

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution and use your notes to build a five-step chart of the war's course: the GENEVA ACCORDS and a divided Vietnam, HO CHI MINH's role, the GULF OF TONKIN RESOLUTION, the TET OFFENSIVE, and CHEMICAL WEAPONS / Vietnamization. Write one sentence on each. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on which step marked the biggest turning point in the war.

DELIVERABLE

Completed five-step chart (one sentence each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the war's greatest turning point.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the five steps pre-placed and a word bank of descriptions to match. Honors: Write a paragraph using the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution to explain how Congress handed the President broad war powers with little debate.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us66-vietnam-war-causes-course-consequences.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-7/us66-vietnam-war-causes-course-consequences.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

The War Powers Resolution (1973) was passed primarily in response to —

- A** Frustration over the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution's failure to prevent further military escalation in Southeast Asia.
- B** Widespread public opposition to the draft lottery system that had supplied troops throughout the Vietnam War.
- C** Nixon's secret and unauthorized bombing of Cambodia revealed in the Pentagon Papers and news reports.
- D** Congress's desire to limit presidential authority to commit U.S. forces to combat without congressional approval.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The War Powers Resolution (1973) was passed primarily in response to —

- A** Frustration over the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution's failure to prevent further military escalation in Southeast Asia.
- B** Widespread public opposition to the draft lottery system that had supplied troops throughout the Vietnam War.
- C** Nixon's secret and unauthorized bombing of Cambodia revealed in the Pentagon Papers and news reports.
- D** Congress's desire to limit presidential authority to commit U.S. forces to combat without congressional approval. ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Congress's desire to limit presidential authority to commit U.S. forces to combat without congressional approval. Choice A is wrong because it describes failure of the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution to prevent escalation, not congress's desire to limit presidential authority to commit U.S. forces to...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Geneva Accords
- Ho Chi Minh's Role
- The Gulf of Tonkin Resolution
- The Tet Offensive
- Chemical Weapons and Vietnamization

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the Vietnam War a justified application of containment or a costly mistake? Argue with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the causes, course, and consequences of the Vietnam War. Give at least one example from each.

STANDARD

US.67

Presidential Vietnam Policies

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Compare the policies and practices of Presidents John F. Kennedy, Lyndon Johnson, and Richard Nixon and their impacts on the continuation of the Vietnam War.

I CAN

I can compare the policies and practices of Presidents Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon and their impacts on the continuation of the Vietnam War.

Words you need before we read

Korean War

En español: *Guerra de Corea*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1950-1953 conflict in which communist North Korea (backed by China and the Soviet Union) invaded South Korea, prompting U.S.-led UN intervention in the first major "hot war" of the Cold War era.

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Check your understanding

Why did the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution give President Johnson broad war powers without a formal declaration?

- A Congress formally declared war on North Vietnam, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B Johnson never received congressional authorization, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C The resolution only authorized economic sanctions, which represents a common misconception about the period, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture
- D The resolution authorized the president to use military force to assist Southeast Asian nations, effectively bypassing the constitutional requirement for a war declaration** ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.66 What was the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution?

2

US.66 Why was the Tet Offensive (1968) a turning point?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Name one of the three presidents who directed the Vietnam War.

✓ **ANSWER**

Kennedy, Johnson, or Nixon.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Three presidents, Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon, each inherited the Vietnam War and each tried a different strategy, from 'flexible response' to massive escalation to 'Vietnamization,' yet each in turn was defeated by the same stubborn conflict.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why did three very different presidents, using three very different strategies, all fail to end the Vietnam War on American terms?

Kennedy's "Flexible Response"

- President Kennedy increased military advisors from 700 to 16,000 and supported the South Vietnamese government through counterinsurgency efforts.
- His "flexible response" doctrine emphasized varied military options rather than relying solely on nuclear deterrence.
- Kennedy avoided large-scale combat deployment, though his increases set the stage for later escalation.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

President _____ approached Vietnam by _____, while President _____ instead _____.

Johnson's Escalation

- President Johnson used the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution to deploy combat troops, eventually reaching 543,000 by 1969.
- He pursued military victory through overwhelming force, including extensive bombing campaigns against North Vietnam.
- Despite massive commitment, military victory proved elusive, and Johnson chose not to seek reelection amid growing opposition.

Nixon's Vietnamization

- President Nixon gradually withdrew American forces while increasing bombing of Cambodia and Laos and transferring combat responsibility to South Vietnamese forces.
- He negotiated the Paris Peace Accords (1973), allowing American withdrawal with "peace with honor." However, South Vietnam fell to communist forces in 1975, two years after American withdrawal.

Effectiveness Analysis

- All three presidents failed to achieve lasting South Vietnamese independence.
- Each escalated American involvement despite growing domestic opposition and limited military success.
- The war demonstrated the limits of American military power against determined guerrilla opposition and the political costs of prolonged, inconclusive warfare.

Key Figures

John F. Kennedy

35th President; sent advisers

- Expanded the number of U.S. military advisers in Vietnam
- Framed Vietnam as a Cold War test of containment
- Left the deepening commitment to Johnson after 1963

STRATEGY Begin the presidential arc with JFK's limited but growing involvement.

Lyndon B. Johnson

36th President; Americanized the war

- Escalated to a large ground and air war after 1965
- Justified it in the Johns Hopkins 'peace without conquest' address
- Chose not to seek reelection as the war divided the country

STRATEGY Contrast LBJ's escalation with JFK's caution and Nixon's withdrawal.

Richard Nixon

37th President; Vietnamization

- Pursued 'Vietnamization' to shift fighting to South Vietnam
- Appealed to the 'silent majority' for patience
- Signed the 1973 ceasefire ending U.S. combat

STRATEGY Close the arc with Nixon turning the war back over to the Vietnamese.

Nixon's "Silent Majority" Speech

President Richard Nixon • November 3, 1969

Close Reading

"We have adopted a plan which we have worked out in cooperation with the South Vietnamese for the complete withdrawal of all U.S. combat ground forces... As South Vietnamese forces become stronger, the rate of American withdrawal can become greater... I call it the Nixon Doctrine."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Nixon's November 1969 'Silent Majority' speech came at a moment of intense anti-war protest—the Vietnam Moratorium of October 1969 had drawn millions of protesters nationwide. Nixon needed to buy time for his plan to gradually withdraw American troops while turning the fighting over to South Vietnamese forces (a strategy he called 'Vietnamization'). His speech was directed at Americans who supported the war but weren't marching in the streets.

ANALYZE

How did Nixon's Vietnam policy differ from Johnson's?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Richard Nixon	WHEN? November 3, 1969	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	----------------------------------	--

Source: [Richard Nixon Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Domino Theory

Teoría del Dominó

say: DOM-ih-noh THEER-ee

DT

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Cold War

Guerra Fría

say: kohld wor

CW

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Proxy War

Guerra por Poder

PW

Conflicts where the United States and Soviet Union supported opposing sides without directly fighting each other, allowing superpower competition while avoiding nuclear war.

Containment Policy

Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Communism

Comunismo

say: KOM-yoo-niz-um

C

A political and economic system where the government owns all property and means of production, theoretically distributing resources equally, practiced in the Soviet Union and opposed by the United States during...

Superpower

Superpotencia

S

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power capable of projecting force globally; during the Cold War, only the United States and Soviet Union qualified as superpowers.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Compare leaders' choices

MODEL PROMPT: How did Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon each handle Vietnam differently?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

JFK sent advisers, LBJ Americanized the war with huge troop numbers, and Nixon pursued Vietnamization and withdrawal. Same war, three different strategies.

THINK ALOUD

Assign each president a one-word policy (advisers / escalate / withdraw).

→ **Now you try:** *Argue which president's Vietnam policy was most defensible, with evidence.*

Three Presidents, One War — Kennedy, Johnson, Nixon

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read Nixon's 'Silent Majority' speech and use your notes to build a three-column chart: KENNEDY (flexible response, advisers), JOHNSON (escalation, ground troops), and NIXON (Vietnamization, gradual withdrawal). For each president, record his main Vietnam policy and one effect it had on the war's continuation. Finish with a one-sentence claim on which president's policy most changed the course of the war, supported by evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-president chart (policy + one effect each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the most consequential policy.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the three presidents pre-labeled and a bank of policies and effects to match.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the 'Silent Majority' speech to explain how Nixon tried to rebuild public support for a war Americans were tired of fighting.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us67-presidential-vietnam-policies.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did Nixon's policy of Vietnamization differ from Johnson's approach to the Vietnam War?

- A** Nixon sought to gradually withdraw U.S. combat troops by transferring military responsibility to South Vietnamese forces, while Johnson had steadily increased American troop levels.
- B** Nixon expanded the ground war into North Vietnam while Johnson had kept fighting limited to South Vietnam.
- C** Nixon negotiated a complete North Vietnamese surrender while Johnson had pursued only a stalemate.
- D** Nixon ended all bombing campaigns in Vietnam while Johnson had relied entirely on air power rather than ground troops.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Nixon's policy of Vietnamization differ from Johnson's approach to the Vietnam War?

- A** Nixon sought to gradually withdraw U.S. combat troops by transferring military responsibility to South Vietnamese forces, while Johnson had steadily increased American troop levels. ✓
- B** Nixon expanded the ground war into North Vietnam while Johnson had kept fighting limited to South Vietnam.
- C** Nixon negotiated a complete North Vietnamese surrender while Johnson had pursued only a stalemate.
- D** Nixon ended all bombing campaigns in Vietnam while Johnson had relied entirely on air power rather than ground troops.

Correct answer: A. Why: Vietnamization transferred combat responsibility to ARVN forces and allowed gradual U.S. troop withdrawal, a stark contrast to Johnson's escalation to over 500,000 troops by 1968.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Kennedy's "Flexible Response"
- Johnson's Escalation
- Nixon's Vietnamization
- Effectiveness Analysis

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Which president's Vietnam strategy was the most, or least, effective, and why? Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Compare how Kennedy, Johnson, and Nixon each approached the Vietnam War, and assess the effectiveness of one of their strategies.

STANDARD

US.68

Vietnam War Home Front Impact

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Evaluate the impact of the Vietnam War on the home front, including: the anti-war movement, draft by lottery, and the role of television and the media.

I CAN

I can evaluate the impact of the Vietnam War on the home front, including the anti-war movement, draft by lottery, and the role of television and the media.

Words you need before we read

Domino Theory

En español: *Teoría del Dominó*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War belief that if one country fell to communism, neighboring countries would also fall like a row of dominoes, justifying U.S. intervention to prevent communist expansion anywhere in the world.

Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Check your understanding

Why did Johnson's massive escalation fail to achieve victory in Vietnam?

- A** Despite 543,000 troops and extensive bombing, conventional military power proved ineffective against guerrilla warfare and a determined enemy fighting on their homeland ✓ KEY
- B** Johnson never significantly escalated American involvement, despite limited evidence supporting this interpretation, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- C** American forces won every major engagement, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which does not align with the documented historical record
- D** Congress prevented Johnson from adequate escalation, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, which represents a common misconception about this historical period

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.67 Name the three presidents who directed the Vietnam War and one strategy each used.

2

US.67 What was Nixon's policy of Vietnamization?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What movement opposed the draft and U.S. involvement in Vietnam?

✓ **ANSWER**

The anti-war movement.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

As body counts climbed and draft notices arrived, the war came home: students burned draft cards, hundreds of thousands marched on Washington, and for the first time Americans watched the brutal reality of war on the evening news in their living rooms.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did television, the draft, and a protest movement turn the Vietnam War into a war fought on the American home front as much as in Vietnam?

The Anti-War Movement

- The movement grew from small protests to massive demonstrations involving millions.
- It included diverse groups: students (SDS), religious leaders, Vietnam veterans, and civil rights activists.
- The movement helped end the war but also created deep social divisions that affected American politics for decades.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Vietnam War divided the home front because _____, _____, and _____.



U.S. Dept. of Defense, October 21, 1967 [National Archives](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Draft by Lottery

- The 1969 lottery system replaced local draft boards' discretionary decisions with random selection based on birthdates.
- This reduced some inequities but maintained class bias since college deferments protected middle-class youth.
- Opposition to the draft contributed to the 26th Amendment lowering the voting age to 18—if old enough to fight, old enough to vote.

Role of Television and Media

- Vietnam became the first "living room war" with nightly television coverage showing combat footage.
- Graphic images of casualties and destruction contradicted official optimism about the war's progress.
- Walter Cronkite's 1968 editorial calling the war a stalemate significantly influenced public opinion, reportedly prompting Johnson to say, "If I've lost Cronkite, I've lost Middle America."

Key Figures

The Antiwar Movement

Students, veterans, and citizens

- Held teach-ins, marches, and the 1967 March on the Pentagon
- Included veterans like John Kerry testifying against the war
- Helped turn public opinion against continued fighting

STRATEGY Use the movement to show citizens shaping policy from outside government.

Elvis Presley

Rock 'n' roll icon (1935-1977)

- Recorded early hits at Memphis's Sun Studio
- Helped launch rock 'n' roll and 1950s-60s youth culture
- Symbolized a new, distinct teenage identity

STRATEGY Use Elvis and Memphis's Sun Studio/Stax to tie the era's culture to Tennessee.

Anti-War Protest Statement

Close Reading

Students for a Democratic Society • 1965

"We are here today to protest a war that is immoral, illegal, and unjust. Our government sends young men to die in a country they cannot find on a map, for reasons that have never been honestly explained. We demand an end to the draft. We demand that our government bring our brothers home. This is not our war."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

As the Vietnam War escalated in the mid-1960s, a massive anti-war movement emerged on college campuses and in cities across America. The Students for a Democratic Society (SDS), draft resisters, Vietnam Veterans Against the War, and peace marchers challenged the government's justifications for the conflict. By 1967, the anti-war movement included figures like Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., who publicly denounced the war as a moral wrong that drained resources from domestic anti-poverty programs.

ANALYZE

What arguments do these protestors make against the Vietnam War?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? Students for a Democratic Society	WHEN? 1965	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Youth Culture

Cultura Juvenil

YC

The distinct set of tastes, music, fashion, and attitudes that emerged among American teenagers in the 1950s and 1960s, marking youth as a powerful new social and economic force.

Elvis Presley

Elvis Presley

EP

Tennessee-born musician who became the "King of Rock 'n' Roll" in the 1950s, bringing Black rhythm and blues to white mainstream audiences and revolutionizing popular music and youth culture.

Stax Records

Stax Records

SR

The influential Memphis record label founded in 1957 that became a leading producer of soul and R&B music, featuring integrated musicians and promoting racial harmony through music.

Rock 'n' Roll

Rock 'n' Roll

RR

A revolutionary music genre that emerged in the 1950s, blending rhythm and blues with country music, challenging racial barriers and traditional values while becoming the soundtrack of youth rebellion.

Sun Studio

Sun Studio

SS

The legendary Memphis recording studio where Sam Phillips produced groundbreaking recordings by Elvis Presley, Johnny Cash, B.B. King, and others, helping create rock 'n' roll and shaping American music.

Television and Mass Media

Televisión y Medios Masivos

TA

The rapid spread of television in the 1950s that transformed American culture, politics, and consumer habits, creating shared national experiences and powerful advertising platforms.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze home-front change

MODEL PROMPT: How did the Vietnam War and youth culture change American society?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Televised combat and rising casualties fueled antiwar protest, while rock 'n' roll and youth culture reshaped identity. The war split the country between generations and views.

THINK ALOUD

Identify one protest and one cultural change from the section.

→ Now you try: *Explain how the two were connected, citing the text.*

The War Comes Home — Vietnam on the Home Front

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Students for a Democratic Society anti-war statement and study the March on the Pentagon photograph. Complete a three-part organizer: (1) the ANTI-WAR MOVEMENT and who joined it; (2) the DRAFT BY LOTTERY and why it fueled protest; (3) the ROLE OF TELEVISION and media in shaping opinion. Add two details per section. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on how the home front changed the way the war was fought and ended.

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-part organizer (anti-war movement / draft lottery / television, 2+ each)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the home front's impact.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the three sections pre-labeled and a word bank of details to place.
Honors: Write a paragraph using the SDS statement to analyze why so many young Americans came to see the war as unjust.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us68-vietnam-home-front-impact.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-7/us68-vietnam-home-front-impact.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How did television coverage of the Vietnam War affect public opinion in the United States?

- A** Television coverage consistently presented the war favorably, boosting public support throughout the conflict.
- B** Graphic images of battlefield casualties and the Tet Offensive brought the realities of war into American living rooms and fueled growing anti-war sentiment.
- C** Television coverage had little effect on public opinion because most Americans did not own televisions in the 1960s.
- D** Television coverage focused exclusively on diplomatic negotiations and avoided showing any combat footage.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did television coverage of the Vietnam War affect public opinion in the United States?

- A** Television coverage consistently presented the war favorably, boosting public support throughout the conflict.
- B** Graphic images of battlefield casualties and the Tet Offensive brought the realities of war into American living rooms and fueled growing anti-war sentiment. ✓
- C** Television coverage had little effect on public opinion because most Americans did not own televisions in the 1960s.
- D** Television coverage focused exclusively on diplomatic negotiations and avoided showing any combat footage.

Correct answer: B. Why: Vietnam became known as 'the living room war.' Tet Offensive footage in 1968 undercut official optimism, and media coverage of casualties, protests, and atrocities directly contributed to the antiwar movement's growth.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Anti-War Movement
- Draft by Lottery
- Role of Television and Media

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the anti-war movement and media coverage shorten the Vietnam War, or simply divide the nation? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the Vietnam War affected the American home front. Address the anti-war movement, the draft, and the media.

STANDARD

US.69

Space Race Competition

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the competition between the U.S. and Soviet Union for superiority in space.

I CAN

I can describe the competition between the U.S. and Soviet Union for superiority in space.

Words you need before we read

Youth Culture

En español: *Cultura Juvenil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The distinct set of tastes, music, fashion, and attitudes that emerged among American teenagers in the 1950s and 1960s, marking youth as a powerful new social and economic force.

Rock 'n' Roll

En español: *Rock 'n' Roll*

WHAT IT MEANS

A revolutionary music genre that emerged in the 1950s, blending rhythm and blues with country music, challenging racial barriers and traditional values while becoming the soundtrack of youth rebellion.

Elvis Presley

En español: *Elvis Presley*

WHAT IT MEANS

Tennessee-born musician who became the "King of Rock 'n' Roll" in the 1950s, bringing Black rhythm and blues to white mainstream audiences and revolutionizing popular music and youth culture.

Check your understanding

What changes did the draft lottery system make and how did it contribute to the 26th Amendment?

A The lottery eliminated all draft inequities, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

B While the lottery added some fairness, class bias remained through deferments, and opposition to drafting 18-year-olds who couldn't vote led to the 26th Amendment ✓ KEY

C The draft had no connection to voting rights, but the historical record tells a more complex story and fails to account for key developments in the broader context

D The lottery was never actually implemented, which does not align with the documented historical record when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.68 How did television change Americans' view of the Vietnam War?

2

US.68 What was the anti-war movement?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What Soviet satellite launch in 1957 started the Space Race?

✓ **ANSWER**

Sputnik.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Shocked when the Soviets launched Sputnik, the first satellite, in 1957, the United States poured its money and genius into a race to space, culminating in July 1969 when an American became the first human to walk on the Moon.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why did reaching the Moon become a matter of national survival, and what did the Space Race reveal about the Cold War competition itself?

Motivations for Space Competition

- Both superpowers sought to demonstrate technological superiority, military capability (ICBMs used space technology), and ideological system effectiveness.
- Space achievements provided international prestige and propaganda value, showing the world which system—capitalism or communism—could better harness technology for great achievements.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Space Race began because _____, and it mattered in the Cold War because _____.

Key Events and Milestones

- Soviet achievements: Sputnik satellite (1957) and Yuri Gagarin becoming first human in space (1961).
- American achievements: John Glenn orbiting Earth (1962) and Apollo 11 moon landing (1969).
- Key figures included Wernher von Braun (American program) and Sergei Korolev (Soviet program).
- The moon landing represented America's decisive victory in the space race.



NSSDC / NASA (replica photographed); donor image released CC0, Replica; original launched October 4, 1957 [Smithsonian](#)

Political Implications

- Early Soviet successes suggested communist system superiority, shocking Americans and prompting increased science education funding.
- Kennedy's commitment to land a man on the moon mobilized national resources.
- The successful moon landing restored American prestige and demonstrated democratic capitalism's capability to achieve great goals.

American Response to Sputnik

- Sputnik prompted creation of NASA (1958), increased science education funding through the National Defense Education Act, and implementation of "duck and cover" drills reflecting fears about Soviet ICBM capability.
- The "Sputnik crisis" transformed American education and accelerated technological development.

Key Figure

John F. Kennedy

35th President; set the Moon goal

- Challenged the U.S. to land a man on the Moon by 1969
- Framed the space race as Cold War competition with the USSR
- Boosted NASA funding after the shock of Sputnik and Gagarin

STRATEGY Use JFK's Moon pledge to show the space race as an arm of the Cold War.

Moon Landing Speech

President John F. Kennedy • May 25, 1961

Contextualization

"I believe that this nation should commit itself to achieving the goal, before this decade is out, of landing a man on the Moon and returning him safely to the Earth. No single space project in this period will be more impressive to mankind, or more important for the long-range exploration of space; and none will be so difficult or expensive to accomplish."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

On July 20, 1969, American astronaut Neil Armstrong became the first human to walk on the moon, fulfilling Kennedy's 1961 challenge. The Apollo 11 mission was the culmination of an eight-year, \$25 billion program employing 400,000 engineers, scientists, and technicians. The moon landing is considered one of the greatest technological achievements in human history and was a decisive victory in the Space Race against the Soviet Union.

ANALYZE

What does Kennedy acknowledge about the moon mission?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President John F. Kennedy	WHEN? May 25, 1961	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
--	--	------------------------------	--

Source: [John F. Kennedy Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Space Race

Carrera Espacial

say: spays rays

SR

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union for supremacy in space exploration, driven by national pride, technological advancement, and military implications of rocket technology.

Arms Race

Carrera Armamentista

AR

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union to develop increasingly powerful nuclear weapons and delivery systems, with each side trying to achieve military superiority.

Military-Industrial Complex

Complejo Militar-Industrial

say: MIL-ih-tair-ee in-DUS-tree-ul KOM-pleks

MC

The close ties among the military, defense contractors, and government that President Eisenhower warned about in 1961 as a driver of unnecessary military spending.

Sputnik

Sputnik

say: SPUUT-nik

S

The world's first artificial satellite, launched by the Soviet Union on October 4, 1957, shocking Americans and triggering fears about Soviet technological superiority and the "missile gap."

Mutual Assured Destruction (MAD)

Destrucción Mutua Asegurada

MA

The Cold War doctrine that nuclear war between the U.S. and Soviet Union would result in complete annihilation of both sides, theoretically preventing either from starting a war.

Superpower

Superpotencia

S

A nation with overwhelming military, economic, and political power able to project force globally; during the Cold War, only the U.S. and Soviet Union qualified.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

[Link competition to progress](#)

MODEL PROMPT: How did Cold War rivalry drive the space race?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Sputnik's 1957 launch shocked the U.S. into funding NASA and education. Kennedy's Moon pledge turned fear of falling behind into a national goal.

THINK ALOUD

Circle the event that pushed the U.S. to act.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how competition, not curiosity, drove the race, citing the text.*

Reaching for the Moon — The Space Race

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read President Kennedy's Moon Landing (Rice University) speech and review the Sputnik photograph. Build a chart tracking four elements: the MOTIVATIONS for the space race, KEY MILESTONES (Sputnik, Explorer I, Gagarin, Apollo 11), the POLITICAL IMPLICATIONS of leading in space, and the AMERICAN RESPONSE to Sputnik (NASA, science education). Write one sentence on each. Finish with a one-sentence claim on how the space race was really an extension of the Cold War, with evidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-element chart (one sentence each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim linking the space race to the Cold War.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the four elements pre-labeled and a word bank of milestones to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph using Kennedy's Rice University speech to explain how he framed a costly, risky moon mission as a national necessity.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us69-space-race-competition.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-7/us69-space-race-competition.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

The United States and Soviet Union competed in the space race throughout the late 1950s and 1960s. Which evaluation of the argument that the space race was primarily an ideological contest rather than a military one is best supported?

- A** The space race was purely ideological because NASA and Soviet space programs were explicitly civilian agencies with no connection to military weapons development.
- B** The space race was simultaneously ideological and military: rocket technology directly advanced ICBM capability, while space achievements served as propaganda demonstrations of systemic superiority for non-aligned nations' benefit.
- C** The space race was primarily military because both superpowers measured success exclusively by advances in satellite reconnaissance technology rather than by human spaceflight achievements.
- D** The space race had neither military nor ideological significance; it was primarily a scientific competition driven by the curiosity of engineers and scientists on both sides, not by government strategic planning.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The United States and Soviet Union competed in the space race throughout the late 1950s and 1960s. Which evaluation of the argument that the space race was primarily an ideological contest rather than a military one is best supported?

- A** The space race was purely ideological because NASA and Soviet space programs were explicitly civilian agencies with no connection to military weapons development.
- B** The space race was simultaneously ideological and military: rocket technology directly advanced ICBM capability, while space achievements served as propaganda demonstrations of systemic superiority for non-aligned nations' benefit. ✓
- C** The space race was primarily military because both superpowers measured success exclusively by advances in satellite reconnaissance technology rather than by human spaceflight achievements.
- D** The space race had neither military nor ideological significance; it was primarily a scientific competition driven by the curiosity of engineers and scientists on both sides, not by government strategic planning.

Correct answer: B. Why: The space race was inseparably both ideological and military: rocket technology capable of launching satellites was identical to the technology needed to deliver nuclear warheads intercontinentally. Sputnik's military significance was that it demonstrated Soviet ICBMs could reach American...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Motivations for Space Competition
- Key Events and Milestones
- Political Implications
- American Response to Sputnik

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was the Space Race mainly about science and exploration, or about Cold War prestige and military power? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the causes and significance of the Space Race. Why did it matter so much during the Cold War?

STANDARD

US.70

Cold War Détente & the Fall of the Berlin Wall

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain developments that eased tensions during the Cold War, including: President Richard Nixon's détente, SALT Treaties, President Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev's INF Treaty, The fall of the Berlin Wall.

I CAN

I can explain developments that eased tensions during the Cold War, including Nixon's détente, SALT Treaties, Reagan and Gorbachev's INF Treaty, and the fall of the Berlin Wall.

Words you need before we read

Space Race

En español: *Carrera Espacial*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union for supremacy in space exploration, driven by national pride, technological advancement, and military implications of rocket technology.

Sputnik

En español: *Sputnik*

WHAT IT MEANS

The world's first artificial satellite, launched by the Soviet Union on October 4, 1957, shocking Americans and triggering fears about Soviet technological superiority and the "missile gap."

Arms Race

En español: *Carrera Armamentista*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union to develop increasingly powerful nuclear weapons and delivery systems, with each side trying to achieve military superiority.

Check your understanding

How did early Soviet successes like Sputnik and Gagarin shock Americans and change education policy?

- A Soviet achievements had no impact on American policy, which does not align with the documented historical record, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- B Americans were not concerned about Soviet space achievements, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic
- C They suggested Soviet technological superiority, prompting NASA's creation, the National Defense Education Act, and massive investment in science education** ✓ KEY
- D Education policy remained unchanged after Sputnik, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion and fails to account for key developments in the broader context

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.69 What was the Space Race, and what triggered it?

2

US.69 What was the climax of the American effort in the Space Race?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What barrier's 1989 fall symbolized the end of the Cold War?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Berlin Wall.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

After decades of terror and confrontation, the Cold War thawed: leaders signed arms-control treaties, an American president stood at the Berlin Wall and demanded 'tear down this wall,' and in 1989 the wall, and soon the Soviet empire itself, came crashing down.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did a conflict that seemed permanent finally come to a peaceful end, and who, or what, brought down the Berlin Wall?

Nixon's Détente Policy

- President Nixon pursued relaxed tensions through diplomatic engagement, cultural exchanges, and arms control negotiations with the Soviet Union.
- This policy, known as détente, resulted in the SALT I Treaty (1972) and improved U.S.-Soviet relations.
- Nixon also opened relations with China, using triangular diplomacy to gain leverage over the Soviets.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Cold War ended as _____ and _____, symbolized by the fall of _____.

SALT Treaties Significance

- The Strategic Arms Limitation Treaties (SALT I & II) represented the first successful nuclear arms control agreements.
- They limited missile deployments and established verification procedures, demonstrating both nations' interest in avoiding nuclear war.
- While not reducing arsenals, they capped the arms race and created frameworks for future negotiations.

Reagan-Gorbachev Contributions

- Despite initial tensions—Reagan called the USSR an "evil empire"—Reagan and Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev developed a personal relationship that led to the Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces (INF) Treaty (1987).
- This treaty eliminated an entire class of nuclear weapons and established precedent for nuclear reductions, not just limitations.

Fall of the Berlin Wall

- The 1989 wall's destruction symbolized communism's collapse and the Cold War's end.
- East German government's inability to maintain control demonstrated the Soviet system's fundamental weakness.
- The wall's fall marked the beginning of German reunification and the Soviet empire's dissolution, ending four decades of Cold War division.



U.S. Dept. of Defense, November 1989 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

Key Figures

Ronald Reagan

40th President (1981-1989)

- Pressed the USSR with military buildup and firm rhetoric
- Demanded 'tear down this wall' at the Brandenburg Gate (1987)
- Negotiated arms cuts with Gorbachev as the Cold War thawed

STRATEGY Use Reagan at the Wall to mark the Cold War's turn toward its end.

Richard Nixon

37th President; architect of détente

- Opened relations with communist China in 1972
- Signed the SALT I arms-limitation treaty with the USSR
- Eased Cold War tensions through 'détente'

STRATEGY Use Nixon's détente to show the Cold War could cool without ending.

Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate

Close Reading

President Ronald Reagan • June 12, 1987

"General Secretary Gorbachev, if you seek peace, if you seek prosperity for the Soviet Union and Eastern Europe, if you seek liberalization: Come here to this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, open this gate! Mr. Gorbachev, tear down this wall!"

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Ronald Reagan's June 1987 speech at the Brandenburg Gate in West Berlin was a defining moment of the late Cold War. The Berlin Wall had divided the city since 1961, symbolizing the Iron Curtain separating Communist Eastern Europe from the democratic West. Reagan's call for Gorbachev to 'tear down this wall' came at a moment of Soviet reform under Gorbachev's glasnost and perestroika policies, signaling that Reagan believed fundamental change in the Soviet empire was possible.

ANALYZE

What challenge does Reagan issue to the Soviet leader?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Ronald Reagan	WHEN? June 12, 1987	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.
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Source: [Ronald Reagan Presidential Library](#)

Word Wall

Iron Curtain

say: EYE-ern KUR-tun

Cortina de Hierro

IC

Winston Churchill's metaphor for the political and military barrier dividing Soviet-controlled Eastern Europe from Western Europe after World War II.

Cold War

say: kohld wor

Guerra Fría

CW

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Communism

say: KOM-yoo-niz-um

Comunismo

C

A political and economic system in which the government owns all property and means of production; practiced in the Soviet Union and opposed by the U.S.

Containment Policy

Política de Contención

CP

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

Arms Race

Carrera Armamentista

AR

The Cold War competition between the United States and Soviet Union to develop increasingly powerful nuclear weapons and delivery systems, with each side trying to achieve military superiority.

NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)

OTAN (Organización del Tratado del Atlántico Norte)

N

The military alliance formed in 1949 by the United States, Canada, and Western European nations pledging mutual defense against Soviet aggression, embodying the principle that "an attack on one is an attack on all."

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Explain how a conflict ends

MODEL PROMPT: How did détente and 1989 bring the Cold War toward its end?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Nixon's détente eased tensions through arms treaties and opening China; later, Reagan's pressure and Gorbachev's reforms led to the Berlin Wall's fall in 1989.

THINK ALOUD

List one step of détente and one sign of the Cold War ending.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain which mattered more - easing tension or applying pressure - with evidence.*

Thawing the Cold War — Détente to the Fall of the Wall

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read President Reagan's Remarks at the Brandenburg Gate and use your notes to build a timeline of four developments that eased and then ended Cold War tensions: NIXON's DÉTENTE, the SALT TREATIES, the REAGAN-GORBACHEV relationship, and the FALL OF THE BERLIN WALL (1989). For each, write one sentence on what it did to reduce tension. Finish with a one-sentence claim, backed by evidence, on what mattered most in bringing the Cold War to a peaceful end.

DELIVERABLE

Completed four-step timeline (how it eased tension each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about what ended the Cold War.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with the four developments pre-placed and a word bank of descriptions to match. Honors: Write a paragraph using Reagan's 'Tear down this wall' speech to argue how words and diplomacy, not just military strength, helped end the Cold War.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-7/us70-detente-fall-of-berlin-wall.pdf](https://cornell-notes.com/unit-7/us70-detente-fall-of-berlin-wall.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

The fall of the Berlin Wall in November 1989 is often presented as a sudden and unpredictable event. Which UNDERLYING CONDITION most enabled the Wall's fall?

- A** Reagan's 'tear down this wall' speech in 1987 directly inspired East German citizens to organize the mass protests that forced the East German government to open the border.
- B** The Wall fell primarily because East German border guards independently decided to allow citizens to cross, acting against the East German government's explicit orders.
- C** Gorbachev's specific decision to allow Eastern Bloc nations to choose their own political systems was the singular cause that made the Wall's fall both possible and inevitable.
- D** The Soviet command economy's chronic underperformance made maintaining Eastern Bloc subsidies unaffordable, creating structural conditions that Gorbachev's reforms and the 1989 protests triggered into collapse.

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

The fall of the Berlin Wall in November 1989 is often presented as a sudden and unpredictable event. Which **UNDERLYING CONDITION** most enabled the Wall's fall?

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- D** The Soviet command economy's chronic underperformance made maintaining Eastern Bloc subsidies unaffordable, creating structural conditions that Gorbachev's reforms and the 1989 protests triggered into collapse. ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: The Berlin Wall's fall was not simply the result of a spontaneous protest or even Gorbachev's reforms in isolation—it was enabled by the decades-long economic underperformance of the Soviet command economy, which made maintaining an extensive Eastern European empire increasingly untenable. By the...

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Nixon's Détente Policy
- SALT Treaties Significance
- Reagan-Gorbachev Contributions
- Fall of the Berlin Wall

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Who deserves the most credit for ending the Cold War, Reagan, Gorbachev, or larger forces beyond any leader? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Analyze how the Cold War came to an end. What role did détente, arms-control treaties, and leaders like Reagan and Gorbachev play?

Unit 7 Complete

The Cold War & Postwar America (1945–1991) · from superpower rivalry, containment, and the Red Scare, through Korea, Cuba, and Vietnam, to nuclear fear, the Space Race, détente, and the fall of the Berlin Wall.

Revisit your unit hook: How could two nations wage a decades-long "war" without ever meeting on the battlefield, and how did it finally end? You can now answer with evidence — from NATO, the Truman Doctrine, and the Berlin Airlift, through McCarthyism, Korea, and the Cuban Missile Crisis, to Vietnam, the anti-war movement, the Space Race, and Reagan, Gorbachev, and the fall of the Wall.

Next: Unit 8 — Postwar Prosperity & 1950s America

Words you need before we read

■ Iron Curtain

En español: *Cortina de Hierro*

WHAT IT MEANS

Winston Churchill's metaphor for the political and military barrier dividing Soviet-controlled Eastern Europe from Western Europe after World War II.

■ Containment Policy

En español: *Política de Contención*

WHAT IT MEANS

The U.S. foreign policy strategy developed by George Kennan in 1947 to prevent the spread of communism by supporting nations threatened by Soviet expansion, forming the basis of Cold War strategy.

■ Cold War

En español: *Guerra Fría*

WHAT IT MEANS

The prolonged geopolitical, ideological, and military rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union from 1945 to 1991, waged through alliances, proxy wars, and an arms race rather than direct combat.

Check your understanding

What significance did the SALT Treaties have for nuclear arms control?

- A SALT treaties had no practical effect, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- B SALT treaties eliminated all nuclear weapons, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research
- C Only the Soviet Union agreed to limitations, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D They were the first successful nuclear arms agreements, limiting missiles and establishing verification procedures that demonstrated both nations wanted to avoid nuclear war** ✓ KEY

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